
FINAL REPORT

**Seventeenth
Annual Meeting
of the
General Service
Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous**

**Roosevelt Hotel
New York
April 17-22, 1967**



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An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other Group Officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s General Services. This report is "confidential" only because in it certain members must be identified by name. The "confidential" designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.

\$1 50 per copy



Sponsorship -- The Hand of A.A.

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Seventeenth Annual Meeting

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Excerpts from

THE CONFERENCE CHARTER

1. *Purpose:* The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the world services and of the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous. The Conference shall be a service body only; never a government for Alcoholics Anonymous.

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2. *Composition:* The Conference (North American Section) shall be composed of State and Provincial Delegates, the Trustees of the General Service Board, Directors, the surviving co-founder of A.A., and Staff Members of Headquarters or foreign Delegates as the Conference may wish to invite.

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3. *Conference Relation to A.A.:* The Conference will act for A.A. in the perpetuation and guidance of its world services, and it will also be the vehicle by which the A.A. movement can express its views upon all matters of vital A.A. policy and all hazardous deviations from A.A. Tradition. Delegates should be free to vote as their conscience dictates; they should also be free to decide what questions should be taken to the group level, whether for information, discussion or their own direct instruction.

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4. *Conference Relation to A.A. Headquarters:* The Conference will replace the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous who formerly functioned as guides and advisers to The General Service Board and its related Headquarters services. The Conference will be expected to afford a reliable cross section of A.A. opinion for this purpose.

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Conference at a Glance

Sponsorship Seen As A.A. Challenge

17th A.A. Conference Reaffirms Old Pledge

The guiding theme, woven into all presentations, discussion and debate of the Seventeenth Annual Conference of A.A. was "Sponsorship — the Hand of A.A."

The challenge, as John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman of the General Service Board pointed out, is to see that this hand is extended to anyone, anywhere, who seeks help for alcoholic problems.

"We must make sure that this hand is strong, firm, welcoming, and ready with the best that A.A. is and can become," said Dr. Norris in opening the Conference.

This is the star to which we have hitched our wagon, the commitment which was made when A.A. was young, and the commitment we reaffirmed in Toronto," he said.

IN MEMORIAM

We of the 17th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous here assembled do lovingly inscribe upon our annals this testament of our gratitude for the life and works of our departed friend, Fay B.

"Let nothing divert us from this purpose," he said. "Let us use our best wits to find and develop more effective ways to attract and aid the 95% of alcoholics whom A.A. has not yet reached effectively, whom we have not reached effectively."

There was unanimous agreement among Conference participants to share the recovery experience with others — to keep the hand of A.A. always extended.

Delegates, Trustees and Staff Members expressed this unity of purpose in a wide range of experience and opinion as to how A.A. can reach out more effectively to the still suffering alcoholic no matter where he or she may

A.A. Fellowship Extended to All

New York, April 22 — Delegates representing A.A. members from all parts of the United States and Canada had shared their experience, strength and hope regarding virtually every phase of the A.A. program by the time they reached the conclusion here today of the 17th General Service Conference.

Delegates at the Roosevelt Hotel deliberated almost around the clock during the five and one-half-day Conference to express the consensus of the Fellowship, reach decisions and provide guidance to their General Service Office in an effort to improve assistance to the groups and maintain our precepts of Recovery, Unity and Service.

Eighty-nine Delegates, elected by groups from every state and province, together with alcoholic and nonalcoholic Trustees from the General Service Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine Directors and Staff Members form the 124-member Conference. Their actions on behalf of the Fellowship guide the operations, activities and policies of the Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine. Some Conference highlights:

G.S. BOARD — Presented five regional Trustee candidates — Maurice R., Southeast; Rollie D., Canada East; Andy A., East Central; Katherine P., Southwest, and Eric B., Pacific — for election to the Board. This brings to eight the number of Regional Trustees, as established at the 1966 Conference. Also elected was General Service Trustee Ruth W., replacing Gene K.

LITERATURE — Announced publication of "A.A. Way of Life," a selection of Bill's writings, and noted widespread acceptance of "What Happened to Joe," a pamphlet in comic-book format.

G.S.O. STAFF — Herb M. announced his retirement next year as General Manager of G.S.O. Selection of successor underway, transition to start January 1st.

FINANCING — Delegates approved increasing the amount an individual can contribute to G.S.O. from \$100 to \$200 a year. Delegate's Finance Committee recommends G.S.B. make use of investment income from reserve fund.

GRAPEVINE — Recommends that groups be urged to sponsor GV subscriptions for prisons and hospitals. Announced publication of 1968 GV photo calendar—*One Day At a Time*.

INTERNATIONAL — G.S.O. to provide guidance to A.A. members in setting up all-European Conference.

INSTITUTIONS — Stressed that immediate sponsorship of the outgoing patient or inmate is of major importance in carrying the message.

1970 CONVENTION — Reported facilities in Miami to be fully adequate, with ample rooms set aside for A.A. needs.

DELEGATES — Voted to continue two-year term for Area Delegates.

CLUBS, REHABS — Approved position papers on (1) the relation of A.A. to rehabs and other such facilities which are not part of A.A. and thus not bound by the Traditions, and (2) clubs which should operate within A.A. Traditions and abide by them to the fullest.

AL-ANON — Approved Guidelines for group separation of A.A. and Al-Anon.

NEW A.A. SIZE

Based on Reports to G.S.O., Spring 1967

	Groups	Members
United States	8,177	139,753
Canada	1,282	18,630
Overseas	2,522	48,082
In Hospitals	561	14,384
In Prisons	737	29,805
Internationalists . .	—	335
Lone Members . . .	—	(626)*
Totals	13,279	251,615

(including "non-reported" members, actual membership is estimated at more than 350,000.)

*These members included in Area totals.

Bill Recalls the Early Days

A highlight of the 17th Annual General Service Conference was, as it has been in past years, the opening night A.A. Meeting. Bill and Lois shared with Delegates the story of the old days — the trouble and despair, the rekindling of faith and the glory of rebirth.

It was in its way a familiar story, similar to hundreds of others heard in A.A. meeting places throughout North America and, indeed, the world. It was also special in its way as all A.A. stories are special — because all A.A. members are individual and unique. But hearing Bill's story was special, too, because it is the first A.A. story and as such has a place in the hearts of all A.A. members wherever they may be. It is a good and simple tale that somehow belongs to more than 400,000 people throughout the world. It will someday belong to many hundreds of thousands more.

But Bill did not only speak of himself. With Lois at his side as she has been over years both good and bad, he spoke of our past. He noted that everything of value that we have is rooted in history — that we are inheritors of the past. The negative events of years gone by take on new meaning because they were stepping stones to new things, he said.

As it has been with individuals, so it has been with our society, Bill said, noting that the surmounting of difficulties has been one of our chief sources of inspiration. He pointed out, for instance, that in back of each of the Twelve Traditions is a negative — that each is deeply rooted in immense travail and anguish which sober alcoholics suffered as A.A. took shape.

Bill spoke, too, of those who were in the right place at the right time in the years before there was an A.A. ... of the psychiatrist, Dr. Carl Jung who after treating the American businessman, Roland, and failing had the humility to tell him to seek out a spiritual experience that might restore him to sanity... of Dr. Silkworth, who with a quality of humanity such as few others have, explained to Lois that Bill suffered from a compulsion to drink that obliterated all choice ... of Ebby who told his story and enabled Bill to identify at depth in an experience that culminated in a transcending spiritual awakening.

"I think it important," Bill said, "that we credit these sources, the hinges on which the door swung open — Anne S. and Lois because they stayed to bring us within reach of the grace that was in store. Since that time our nonalcoholic friends have become legion. They have contributed in the early times and since. We have no means of expressing our thanks for their individual gifts and talents except to say that God has been very good to us in A.A."

A REGULAR A.A. MEETING

The A.A. meeting was led by Clare G., Delegate from Western Ontario, who identified as one who once stood outside an A.A. meeting hoping "that someone I knew would come along so I could go inside. But no one did, so I drove the back-country roads trying to stay away from a drink." Today, he said, "I have worked my way up to a contented sobriety by doing my best to become a part of A.A."

Ginny D., Delegate from Maryland, spoke of the years "when the world was against me," of being afraid to live and afraid to die and finding an area in between with the help of alcohol... of drinking for ten months in A.A. and then coming back to the program for herself... of reaching a point in her sobriety where she knew that she would again be in serious trouble if she didn't

work on herself and the Twelve Steps. "A.A. has given direction to my life, enabled me to coexist with the human race, and allowed me to find the joy and reward of giving. I feel there is no limit to what can happen in my life if I continue to work the A.A. program," she said.

Bill J., Delegate from Southwest Ohio and Northern Kentucky, spoke on responsibility — his responsibility for ruining a couple of lives. He spoke, too, of lost jobs and bad checks, of being arrested and of crying as he watched daytime soap operas. Bill came to A.A. for two or three years, working his way through eight sponsors (two at a time) before he was ready. His wife was about to leave, he was about to lose his job and thought he was going to die. He prayed! No bargains! He just wanted out. And since that day he has had no desire to drink. From that time responsibility has played a large part in his life. He accepted the responsibility of sponsorship, of becoming a G.S.R. and of being a Delegate. In accepting responsibility, he has also delegated it to his Committeemen and G.S.R.'s, asking them to keep the groups informed and aware of the work that needs to be done. "The acceptance of responsibility," he said, "is the key to success in A.A."

TO
HERB M.
IN APPRECIATION
FOR 15 YEARS OF SERVICE
FROM
THE DELEGATES OF THE
17TH GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS
APRIL 22, 1967

Copy of plaque presented by Delegates at the 17th General Service Conference to Herb M. upon announcement of his retirement as General Manager of G.S.O.

HERB M. TO RETIRE

Herb M., General Manager of G.S.O., announced his retirement to take effect next March.

"Retirement is my idea — solely mine," he said. "Seven years ago I had a heart attack and recovered. In the intervening years I've been in wonderful health. But the fact is that I've been running hard — frequently too hard — ever since I came into A.A. 23 years ago. I would like to move into some easier years, some years of lighter responsibility. And I decided to do that before I wake up and discover that it's later than I think."

A special committee has been reviewing applications for the next General Manager over the last few months. There are a number of candidates and a selection is probable by the July Board meeting. A smooth change-over will start January 1, marking the opening of another chapter in our G.S.O. history.

Sponsorship Seen Challenge For A.A. Over Next Decade

Sponsorship

Presentation

The challenge of the next ten years is to extend the hand of A.A. to anyone, anywhere, who seeks help for alcoholic problems, said John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman of the General Service Board at the opening session of the Seventeenth General Service Conference of A.A.

"We must make sure that this hand is strong, warm, welcoming, and ready with the best that A.A. is and can become," he said. "This is the star to which we have hitched our wagon — the commitment which was made when A.A. was young, and the commitment we reaffirmed in Toronto.

"Let nothing divert us from this purpose," he said. "Let us use our best wits to find and develop more effective ways to attract and hold the 95% of alcoholics whom A.A. has not yet reached effectively, whom we have not reached effectively.

"We know there are many who need A.A. whom we are not reaching, that there are some who turn away after a meeting or two, that there are some who after months or years of active membership drift away. This has been, is now, and will continue to be our big job," he said.

Listing some specific areas of challenge that can be seen now, Dr. Norris said that the comic-book pamphlet is a first step in trying to reach those who for some reason read little or not at all — that this might be a way of reaching those who with few of the advantages of life have been relatively unsuccessful in A.A.

Another area of challenge cited by Dr. Norris is in improving working relationships with professionals in medicine, social work and the clergy who are interested and involved in the field of alcoholism. "This requires tolerance, understanding and respect of each other as individuals. We must talk through our differences, learn from each other, recognize and accept our own limitations and each other's strengths," he said.

There is also a challenge in encouraging A.A. development in other countries and cultures, Dr. Norris said. "We have been confirmed in our belief that A.A. is real — that the A.A. way of life is universally true. We must give advice and encouragement when we are asked, communicating with the language of the heart."

We must also improve both the breadth and depth of our approach to the general public, he said. "We have been unbelievably fortunate in the understanding and support of the communications media. We must show our gratitude and do all that we possibly can to keep their understanding and knowledge of A.A. true and vital."

We face another challenge in strengthening our official interpretation of A.A. at professional meetings, he said, noting that exhibits, meetings, personal contacts and presentations of talks are some of the ways we can develop interest among professionals.

A final challenge is in strengthening communications between present and past Delegates, the Trustees and the groups, said Dr. Norris. "Let us all use Box 4-5-9, the Grapevine and other ways to keep in touch."

It might seem that the challenges to A.A. as a whole are confused with those to each of us as individuals, he said, noting a

conviction that the two cannot be separated. "What people think about A.A. is made up of what people think about you and me."

A.A. is hurt when we break someone's anonymity and it is strengthened when we live the program with the best guidance we can get in the Eleventh step, he said. "As a movement we will meet successfully all the challenges that will come our way if we live by the Second Tradition," he concluded.

A GRATIFYING EXPERIENCE

The Conference in which we are about to participate will be one of the most gratifying experiences of our lives, Virgil W., Area Delegate Chairman, said in welcoming participants to the opening session of the Seventeenth General Service Conference of A.A.

"Now that we are here," he said, "we shall seek success. But because we are men and not gods, we will not always succeed. However, each of us in his own way will strive to do what he thinks best for A.A. as a whole.

"I am sure you all rejoice with me in the rich rewards promised for our efforts, for we shall keep faith with an old commitment and explore new opportunities," he said. "We shall recommit ourselves to the guidance of the God of our understanding, the Greater Power that brought us from defeats of our own making to inspired triumphs over a dreadful adversary."

Recalling the physical and mental horror of his own last drunk, Virgil reminded Conference participants that "this is where you, our Delegates, alcoholic Trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staff Members came from. This is where all of our successors shall come from. We shall visit these drunken hells to find the men and women who shall become our G.S.R.'s, Delegates and Trustees, and they will carry on our Fellowship for others to come.

"This is 'Sponsorship — The Hand of A.A.'," he said. "Freely we received and freely we must give. So it is that we who have been reclaimed from disaster areas of life find ourselves, year after year, more largely engaged in a greater human reclamation project. May God be with and guide each of us as we carry out our responsibilities."

'DELEGATES ONLY' MEETING

Conference Action

Among the subjects discussed at the Area Delegates Only Meeting at the 17th General Service Conference were:

1. How to enliven service meetings with interesting reports.
2. Presenting spiritual aspects of A.A. to the newcomer.
3. A three-year term for Delegates.
4. The possibility of updating the "Third Legacy Manual," with recommendation that a uniform service structure for the state level be included.

Dave C., North Carolina was elected Area Delegate Chairman for the 1968 General Service Conference.

Virgil W., Area Delegate Chairman

SPONSORSHIP: SIX POINTS

Digest of Agenda

MONDAY, APRIL 17

Registration and Tour of G.S.O.
Welcome Session and Keynote.
A.A.W.S. Report. Review of Conference Agenda and Committees.
Opening Dinner. Regular A.A. Meeting.

TUESDAY, APRIL 18

Joint Meetings of Trustees Committees and Conference Committees.
Conference Committee Meetings.
Sponsorship — The Hand of A.A.
General Service Board Report.
Board Finance and Policy Committee Reports.
Individual Contribution Ceiling.
"Area Delegates Only" Dinner and Meeting.

WEDNESDAY, APRIL 19

Communications within A.A.
A.A.'s Role in the Field of Alcoholism.
New Tools for Sponsorship.
Nominating Committee Report.
Regional Trustee Elections.

THURSDAY, APRIL 20

Grapevine.
The Hand of A.A. Inside the Walls.
*Interview Time
Conference Committee Meetings.
Workshop and Sharing Sessions Re: Past Delegates, Committee Structure and Assemblies.

FRIDAY, APRIL 21

Conference Committee Reports, Discussion and Action.
Carrying the Message Overseas.
A.A.'s Position Regarding Clubs — Rehabs.
Three-Year Delegate Term Effective 1970.
How Can Delegates Make a Conference Report that Groups Will Want to Hear?
How Can Spiritual Aspect of A.A. be Presented to Newcomer?
Sponsorship and Growth.
Guidelines of Good Sponsorship.

SATURDAY, APRIL 22

Closing Brunch

* * * * *

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Each day time was set aside to hear Area Delegates of Panel 17 report on A.A. in their territories. Excerpts from these are carried on pages 16-18.

"ASK-IT BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered at various times. Summaries of these are found in appropriate places in this Report.

"INTERVIEW TIME": Six specific questions were put to Delegates in six separate sections. Summaries of their answers and suggestions are reported in appropriate places in this Report.

Presentation

"That which we give away we keep. That which we keep we lose. Such is the basis of our responsibility — to pass on to another alcoholic the message of love and understanding that made our own sobriety possible."

Thus Herb M., Chairman of A.A. World Services, summed up the deliberations of Conference members in noting that "There has been unanimous agreement among us that the very substance of our sobriety lies in our willingness and our readiness to share this recovery experience with another.

"When A.A. was very young, that was our commitment," he said. "Today our determination to keep the hand of A.A. always extended is just as strong. This was made very evident two years ago in Toronto when the Responsibility Declaration was first subscribed to."

Herb presented six guidelines which had emerged from presentations, discussions and deliberations of Delegates and other Conference members:

1. There has been no lessening of the importance of sponsorship in our way of life. Our sponsoring of another alcoholic is more than an expression of our gratitude — it is essential to the continuation of our own recovery.
2. The lowering of average age of the newcomer emphasizes the practical advantage of presenting the A.A. program so that the younger, less beat-up drunk can understand it.
3. Sponsorship still means *personal* sponsorship. But sponsorship can become part of group life with every member encouraged to play a part in welcoming in the newcomer.
4. A.A. literature has always been essential to any sponsorship program. This is more true than ever, now that a broader range of Conference-approved books and pamphlets is available.
5. Sponsorship of alcoholics in institutions has come a long way since the first drunk was found "inside" and told about the A.A. program. But the work still calls for patience and love and understanding.
6. Outside organizations set up a two-way channel for sponsors. They can send us drunks to sponsor. They can help us with pigeons when the problems get beyond recovery into job and finances and marital situations.

Noting the need to work constructively with outside organizations, Herb said that we should not, however, depend on others to do our work — to mobilize our effort. "Sponsorship is A.A.'s job," he said. "No one can interpret the A.A. program to another drunk as well as an A.A. can.

"By the same token," he said, "we need to contain our sponsorship efforts — not to let them spill over into the provinces of the physician, the psychiatrist, the clergyman, the marital counselor."

A.A.'s strength lies in personal sponsorship — in the warmth and understanding of thousands like ourselves who will extend their hands to the suffering alcoholic whoever and wherever he may be, said Herb, urging Conference members "to be thankful that the suffering alcoholic needs us — for in helping him we add new life to our own sobriety — making it doubly secure — making it immeasurably more meaningful."

Love, Service, Responsibility All Add Up To Sponsorship

Sponsorship

Presentation

ship — the Hand of A.A."

Sponsorship is an outlet for giving, for continuing the flow through of sobriety to another human being, he said.

Work with newcomers gives us a positive unselfish way to look at yesterday, to see ourselves as we were and to remind us of our own character defects. It teaches us lessons we may have forgotten as well as patience, an awareness of our own limitations and the part that the love of God has to play in the recovery of all alcoholics.

GENERAL SERVICE AND NEWCOMERS

It is important that new as well as old members understand General Service and know they are part of it.

As Bill said in Concept One: "The final responsibility and the ultimate authority for A.A. world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship."

Thus, all members should be informed as to the functions and needs of all our services. It is not enough to say, "Read 'A.A. Comes of Age'," "Study the 'Third Legacy Manual'," or "Wait until you've been around a few years."

Older members in Oregon seem reluctant to become involved in service work. As a result we find more and more one- and two-year members serving as G.S.R.'s and Committee Members.

Furthermore, the backbone of our service structure in Oregon is composed of those who became involved after only one or two years of sobriety. They have remained active and devoted. It is they who withstand disappointment and criticism, who now see the errors in the past and are trying to do something about them.

All Committee Meetings and Assemblies are open to all A.A. members. This results in better understanding of service by the membership. New people become interested and do much of the service work. Contributions increase when members know why they contribute.

General Service must be made attractive and nothing is less attractive than something we don't understand. The responsibility of making G.S.O. attractive rests with the Delegate and Committee Members.

General Service begins the moment a new member drops his first coin into the basket to help carry the message of our Fellowship to alcoholics anywhere and everywhere.

It begins when he learns that the pamphlets he reads are a result of all members sharing their experience through G.S.O.

It begins when he learns that A.A. isn't just his group, that he and his group are a part of a whole.

It begins when he thanks God for the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. It always begins. It never ends. —Ed D., Oregon

DANGERS OF POOR SPONSORSHIP

We have been looking at sponsorship from a constructive point of view. Perhaps we should view the other side of the coin and the dangers of poor sponsorship. Poor sponsorship is not intentional, yet the harm can be great and long-lasting. Let us look at some examples:

1. *Poor Group Sponsorship* — A newcomer goes to a meeting alone. After the meeting oldtimers talk to each other, leaving the new person alone and confused.
2. *Failure to Introduce the New Member* — The new member is not introduced to others at the meeting, nor is he given phone numbers in case he needs a contact between meetings.
3. *Poor Follow-up* — The sponsor feels his job is ended after taking the newcomer to one or two meetings. If he fails to show up, he is written off as a slipper and no effort is made to get him to return.
4. *Lack of Effort* — A prospect isn't enthusiastic about what we have to offer, so we don't put much effort into the call. He doesn't seem to be ready. We forget that many people who came to A.A. before they were ready are still sober. A little extra patience and effort may be all that is needed.
5. *Possessiveness* — We're such good sponsors that we're sure the newcomer can't get along without our advice in all his affairs. We don't let go. We take up all his time and don't let him make new friends. We give him a feeling of obligation instead of fellowship.
6. *Thirteenth-Stepping* — We try to help with things that are not covered by the program. We give an impression that A.A. is a cure-all, that it solves marital affairs, money and job problems.
7. *Making A.A. a Religious Program* — We preach our religion to newcomers, when the spiritual side of the program as outlined in the Twelve Steps does the job.
8. *Failure to Share A.A. Knowledge* — We do not share the A.A. slogans, the 24-hour program or any of the other tools to work with between meetings.
9. *Playing at Medicine* — When in doubt we fail to seek medical aid. Results can be fatal.
10. *Failure to Provide Literature* — We fail to remember that the newcomer will be alone when he leaves the meeting. Written words can do wonders, preventing him from taking that first drink.
11. *Failure to Stress "No Dues or Fees"* — We forget to tell the newcomer that he is not required to put anything in the basket until financially able to do so, thus causing him embarrassment.

These are only some of the things related to poor sponsorship. We should be as careful with another's sobriety as we are with our own, remembering that the newcomer's life and future may depend on us. Thus we should beware the dangers of poor sponsorship. —Clarence K., Michigan

See Need For Personal Touch

Presentation

Although A.A.'s strength lies in personal sponsorship, it also lies in the warmth and understanding of thousands of others like ourselves.

Though personal, or individual sponsorship adds greatly to the strength of A.A. as a whole, so does the presence of others at an A.A. meeting. The most vivid memory of a first meeting for many of us is of happy, smiling faces and warm friendly hands of other members in attendance.

There was a need for a personal relationship, however. We needed to turn to someone else for help in our utter loneliness. Then one day along came someone to save the day for us — someone to close the gap, to fill the void. Someone who understood.

We began searching for the answer and the strength of personal sponsorship entered the picture when we found someone willing to listen and to help.

Carrying the message through sponsorship not only enriches the lives of others, it enables us to keep growing. Each Twelfth-Step call we make enables us to take away more than we bring. The very essence of this strength through personal sponsorship is our God-given love for our fellow man.

Personal sponsorship is not a matter of individuality. It is a matter of empathy — of identifying with others. Where there is empathy one person can identify with hundreds, even thousands. The relationship is a little like parents love for children. That love is not diminished because there are many. It seems, rather, to increase in intensity the more there are to lay claim to it.

—Kerry L., Nebraska

BEGINNERS MEETINGS IMPORTANT

An experienced A.A. member should supervise Beginners' Meetings since this first impression of A.A. will determine a newcomer's attitude toward the Fellowship.

If at such a meeting the newcomer is convinced that he needs A.A., he will attend meetings regularly. Otherwise he will have no reason to attend, since curiosity is usually satisfied without much investigation.

The beginner is usually a person who has so isolated himself that true, honest fellowship of one man with another has become a fiction in his mind. He has relied upon the anesthesia of alcohol to avoid factual reality for so long that he is now comparable to a captain on a ship that has lost its rudder, to say nothing of map and compass.

Alcoholism is a moral problem to the public in general and the newcomer is usually ashamed to make the admission that he is an alcoholic. For this reason the concept of alcoholism as a mental, physical and spiritual disease should be fully explained.

Until the beginner understands that his drinking problem is a thinking problem and that he has habitually degenerated his will power to the point where it is no longer dependable, he will not honestly admit that his life has become unmanageable.

Once he is convinced that his life has become unmanageable, however, it is possible that the instinct for survival will assert itself in a sincere desire to find a solution to his problem. It is

also imperative for the beginner to realize that only a "power greater than himself can restore him to sanity." Then he can willingly turn control of his life over to the care of God as he understands Him, thus finding his way to recovery.

—Ken K., California

LONERS STAY SOBER

Report

A Lone Member is one who, by reason of geography or physical disability is unable to attend A.A. meetings. There are 260 Loners in the United States and Canada, and 366 in overseas areas.

Through correspondence with G.S.O. and A.A. literature they stay sober. Some of them have never had an opportunity to attend a regular A.A. meeting.

Many maintain their sobriety under very difficult conditions. Presently there are several Loners in Viet Nam. They find it difficult to contact each other, yet their letters are among the most cheerful we receive.

New Loners receive a letter with material based on the shared experience of other Loners. They are encouraged to write to other Loners and share their "experience, strength and hope" as well as to correspond with G.S.O.

Each Lone Member receives a *Loners Meeting* which is mailed on alternate months with Box 4-5-9. This two-page bulletin is made up of excerpts from Loners' letters received at the office. Thus each month they receive some mailing from us, in addition to correspondence.

Loner sponsors are all A.A.'s who enjoy writing letters and have asked to do this type of 12th-Step work. There are many who are attracted to the idea of extending the hand of A.A. in this way. Every time a story in Box 4-5-9 touches on this service, we receive additional requests to join this Loner-Sponsor Group.

Loners are also encouraged in every effort to "carry the message" in their communities, as evidenced by the fact that many flourishing groups today resulted from the effort initiated by one Lone Member.

—Eve M., G.S.O. Staff,
Lone Members

Ask-It-Basket

Q What is the Delegates' experience concerning beginners' meetings. What determines their need? Is there a programmed format?

A Due to the growth of A.A. and expanding interests of members, beginners tend to get lost. Beginners meetings were started to bring about closer contact, to tell them the A.A. story, instill a better understanding of A.A. and make them aware of pitfalls. The new "Beginners' Meeting Kit" available from G.S.O. will be helpful in conducting such meetings.

Sponsor Gives Love, Accepts Responsibility

Sponsorship

Presentation

We either sponsor and grow or we become indifferent to others' needs and our Fellowship becomes extinct.

Sponsorship must be an unselfish act in which personal achievement plays no part. I believe that there comes to each of us in our efforts a time when we must recognize this and guide a newcomer to another person who might be better suited to the particular job.

We need help in supplying the needs of each person whom we sponsor. No two people have the same needs. One person needs to be helped longer than another. Certain people must be handled in a firmer manner than others.

We must bear our limitations in mind — that we are simply alcoholics sharing what has been given to us. We are not marriage counselors, psychiatrists or clergymen. We must be flexible. There are no hard and fast rules. We must adjust our thinking and our approach as times change and additional help becomes available.

May our dedication to helping others increase, so that we may gain by giving and sharing. May we remember that we simply carry the message and that it is a loving God who gives Grace "that passeth all understanding."
—Robert W., Indiana.

POINTS FOR HELPING NEW AND AILING GROUPS

New groups should first decide upon a time and place to meet — a room in a church or civic building which does not charge rent. A contribution should be made, however, and the new group should not shirk responsibilities to the local Intergroup Office or G.S.O.

Open meetings are best to start in communities where there is no other A.A. Relatives and friends can attend to find out about A.A. Officers should be elected and the group registered with G.S.O., Intergroup and the Conference Area Assembly office.

The community should be advised that there is an A.A. group in town. Contact law enforcement agencies, ministers, and doctors. Place an ad in the local paper and get a number listed in the telephone directory. Let other A.A. groups know of the meeting. Visit their meetings and invite them to yours.

There are a number of problems which may afflict an ailing group — money, leadership, poor programs, lack of cooperation with other groups, and lack of sponsorship.

If there is too much money, it should be given away. If too little, the group should cut expenses, learn to live out of the basket — that is, *voluntary* contributions.

If there is a leadership problem, the group should look for trusted servants among its newer members. Every member should be given a voice in group affairs.

If there is a lack of cooperation with other groups, members should visit other groups and take part in A.A. activities in the Area. They should also see what makes the successful groups tick.

Webster defines a sponsor as one who is willing to take the responsibility for another person or thing. I believe that sponsorship and growth are inseparable.

If there is a sponsorship problem, the group should make it a point to see that Twelfth-Step calls are followed up and that newcomers are taken care of.

Some suggestions that might be applied to both new and ailing groups might include: Have two members always present, on time, and with coffee each meeting night; follow up every Twelfth-Step call; have a planned program every meeting; follow the Twelve Traditions, particularly about money and trusted servants; purchase literature for the group and encourage Grapevine subscriptions.

The group should also visit and cooperate with other groups participating in local A.A. affairs; start and continue an effective sponsorship program, following up every Twelfth-Step call; remember the group's primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, and finally that the one rule is that there are no rules.
—Ray D., Tennessee

NEED TO REACH YOUNG PEOPLE

Poor sponsorship in an Area is a sign of complacency and we need to look for new ways to reach the young people who are coming into A.A. before hitting bottom.

One way to convince a newcomer is by explaining the progression of the disease and showing him how it can be offset by the power of the Fellowship of A.A. Few of us come to A.A. with a desire to stop drinking forever. We want sobriety now, and it should be explained that this is what the program offers.

The newcomer should be made aware of the hospitality and friendship A.A. has to offer. The sponsor should make sure a few members give their full names and phone numbers. Call during the day and if he wants to go to a meeting, volunteer to pick him up, or make sure someone is there to meet him.

It is also good for the sponsor to get to know the family, to suggest a family meeting or Al-Anon for relatives.

The newcomer should be convinced that the disease of alcoholism cannot be cured, that he faces insanity or death if he continues to drink and no one returns to normal drinking. He should also be told of those who have gone out and tried it and now are dead.

I feel that it may scare a newcomer away to hear too many people expound their spiritual beliefs over and over again, also that the so-called "authoritative A.A." is a detriment. Few newcomers, filled with fear and apprehension, are willing to put their trust in "authority."
—Ted K., Alberta

HOSPITALITY

Delegates voiced special thanks again in 1967 for the time and effort given by members of the Hospitality Committee in providing Delegates' wives with entertainment, sightseeing tours, visits to N.Y.C. Intergroup and Al-Anon headquarters, TV shows, museum tours, shopping trips and other activities, not the least of which was a hospitality suite where from 40 to 80 people a day dropped in to chat with local A.A. members who were on duty to serve coffee and give advice and direction to anyone needing it.

Behind Walls Because of Alcohol

Institutions

Presentation

In introducing participants in the Institutions Presentation — "The Hand of A.A. Inside the Walls" — Austin McCormick, nonalcoholic Trustee and penal authority, noted that although accurate figures are hard to come by, a great many of those in jail throughout the nation are there because of alcohol. He cited a California study which showed that 30-35% of inmates had a serious problem with alcohol, while alcohol played a part in the crimes of 50% of the inmates.

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REACHING INSIDE THE WALLS

The system in New Jersey of getting groups to take meetings into institutions is for the Chairman of each institution to attend the quarterly meeting exchange and sign up twelve or thirteen groups to bring meetings over the next three months. This way each group participates once every three months.

We try to get both former inmates and those who have never been institutionalized to speak. We warn them against taking letters out for inmates or doing other "favors," and suggest that all they do is share the A.A. program.

Whenever possible we try to obtain separation of alcoholics and mental patients. We also try to see that alcoholic patients are given A.A. literature before attending their first meeting. This way they can become acquainted with the program and see how A.A. can help them.

As another part of our institutional program in New Jersey, we try to get men and women to visit alcoholic inmates in the various institutions if it is allowed. If the inmate sees that there are people on the outside who really care, they are much more apt to come to A.A. once they are released.

We also have Christmas and anniversary parties with home-made cakes, candy, and all the trimmings for the institutional groups. Sometimes as many as 30 or 40 outside members will attend.

Although we have tried different types of meetings — questions and answers, discussions, etc. — outside speakers are most popular. Whenever possible we try to have both women and men speakers.

When they let us know, we try to meet inmates upon release. We also urge their families to attend a few A.A. meetings so they will not only encourage the alcoholic to attend, but so they will have a better understanding of the disease of alcoholism.

—Paul H., New Jersey

SPONSORSHIP OF INMATES

Sponsorship for A.A. members newly released from institutions is handled in many ways in Northwestern Ohio. One of these is through cooperation with Big Brothers of A.A., a group of A.A. members who help imprisoned and paroled alcoholics find the road to recovery.

Members of Big Brothers, which is not affiliated with A.A., contact released inmates whenever called upon. As soon as word is received that an inmate has been released, every effort is made to establish contact and get him to a meeting where he is made to feel welcome and at home. Big Brothers may also help the parolee find employment and a place to stay.

Big Brothers also carry the message inside the walls at least twice a month, correspond with inmates and take part in after-meeting discussions. Another activity is speaking at "pre-release" meetings in the institutions. They tell inmates what to expect on the outside and where help can be found in A.A.

Big Brothers work closely with parole officers, the courts and families of released inmates in order to obtain as much harmony and understanding as possible. They follow through until the parolee's recovery is complete or until they know definitely that he no longer cares for A.A. help. Although not always successful, the Big Brothers are reasonably sure that they have made every effort to carry the message to the released alcoholic.

—Elmer L., Ohio

SERVICE TO INSTITUTIONS

Report

In 1966 the hand of A.A. reached into a total of 737 prison groups with a membership of 29,805 and 561 hospital groups with a membership of 14,384 in the United States, Canada and overseas.

Regular G.S.O. services to these groups include: distribution of complimentary literature, directories, and bulletins, as well as personal correspondence with groups, members and Institutional Committees.

The exchange of publications, tapes, and correspondence among the institutional groups themselves seems to be a very effective way in which these A.A.'s can share with each other. Many of their publications are of a very high order, interesting reading for A.A.'s anywhere.

The Conference Institutions Committee, formed at the 1966 General Service Conference, meets for the first time at the 1967 Conference. We have high hopes that the Committee will help suggest ways to improve our G.S.O. services to institutional groups, as well as local and area services.

A.A. groups inside the walls experience and present problems that are not common to outside A.A. groups. Through the Conference Committee, we hope to have a widespread sharing regarding A.A. Traditions in institutions (especially membership regulations and self-support); use of the *World Directory*; literature supply, and release sponsorship, among other topics.

—Cora Louise B., G.S.O. Staff,
Institutions.

NEED FOR LITERATURE

Interview Time

In view of the crying need for literature in most institutions, could a regular planned supply of literature for institutions be provided by the area Committee when other arrangements are lacking? Although most Delegates thought this was being well taken care of in their own areas at the local level, they did agree that the area Committees should step in when such was not the case. Some comments:

1. Institutional literature taken care of at local level by institution committee and groups.
2. General Service Office should offer a discount or package deals for institutional literature.
3. Area Committee should form institutional committee when one is not in existence.

COURT CLASSES WORK

Presentation

We call them Court Classes rather than Honor Courts in Arizona because that is what we try to make them — classes on the disease of alcoholism.

Court Classes began in Phoenix more than three years ago when a judge offered his help to an A.A. member who had once approached him on the subject. Today there are 10 Court Classes in 10 cities throughout the state.

Our judges have taken a great interest in the classes after realizing the futility of jailing an alcoholic for 30 days only to have him back the day after being released.

By working with A.A. members judges have found a way to expose alcoholics to the knowledge that alcoholism is a disease and to a program of recovery. If they attend four of these classes, alcoholics at least learn enough so they can no longer plead ignorance.

We appear in court at 7 a.m. when they bring in the drunks. We are there as individuals, and sit through the sentencing of 40 to 100 or more men and women. At this time the judge explains that there are members of A.A. present who will talk to anyone about the A.A. program. Later we talk to the judge about various cases, expressing our opinion as to whether a person has a problem or is sincere in wanting help.

Court Classes are held once a week, with those so sentenced required to attend four in succession. All meetings are presided over by A.A. members, with a city magistrate present. Programs are arranged in detail, with speakers and subjects, such as "alcoholism the disease," selected in advance. Other A.A. members present may be asked to tell some of their drinking stories for a few minutes.

The Court Class is not an A.A. meeting. A.A. members are there only to carry the message to those who have been sentenced, rather than to resolve their own problems. We try to give the idea that the A.A. program can provide a solution to the drinking problem, but we do not dwell on any one aspect of the program.

We have A.A. members who have come through Court Classes, but it is hard to say how many. Some go through and turn up at A.A. months later. One thing we are sure of is that we can talk to 40 or more people each week who are in trouble because of alcoholism and willing to listen. It might be another jail, another 30 days, five years or never, before they hear of A.A. some other way.

—Paul R., Arizona

INSTITUTIONAL A.A. GROWS

The hand of A.A. has been extended inside the walls of institutions and prisons, intensively in some areas, in the 25 years since institutional A.A. began.

Although we have added only 14 new institutional groups in the past year, estimated membership has increased by over 7,000. This indicates the message is being carried by outside sponsors, by literature and tapes, by films and correspondence.

Yet, it is still a struggle to provide enough literature on planned basis to interest enough A.A.'s in carrying the message inside, to insure sponsorship upon release.

As a prison Chaplain and A.A. member writes, we still ask more in a sense of institutional A.A. members in the way of proving themselves than we do of others when it comes to making his

Institutions

own contact as proof of his sincerity and proof that he has gotten the A.A. message inside the walls:

"If we expect the convict to make his own contact, we are demanding more from him than we do from the 'squares' who, filled with all kinds of living problems arising from their drinking, are, nevertheless, vastly more uncomplicated than the man coming out of jail. If we accompany 'squares' to their first meeting, why deny 'cons' who need it so much more?"

A secretary of the Institutional Committee for a large western prison writes: "The life of institutional A.A. depends on the living proof we are able to offer these men, who have never been afforded this opportunity on the streets, that this philosophy and way of life work."

He notes, furthermore, that the greatest number of violations occur within the first 90 days after release, due mostly to an insecure, alienated feeling and the inability to cope with it. Liquor may seem to offer a way out.

Take the case of a man who was given fifteen years for robbing a bank while in a complete blackout. He writes: "I had promised my wife that I would turn myself in to a hospital that very morning. I just stopped for one last drink before going. The last I remember I was in a bar. I left it at 3:00 o'clock and was arrested at 3:25.

"I tried to be acquitted on temporary insanity, but to no avail. It may sound strange, but now I am glad I wasn't acquitted, because I found A.A. since coming here, and I know now that had I been acquitted, I would have remained as I was."

This, I believe, is eloquent testimony to the kind of job that we can do when we accept the full responsibilities of A.A. sponsorship and extend the hand of A.A. inside the walls to those who cannot come to us for help.

Cora Louise B., G.S.O. Staff,
Institutions

LITERATURE FOR INMATES

Conference Action

The Institutions Committee of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That A.A.'s carrying the message to institutions abide by regulations and cooperate with personnel.
2. That A.A. groups and members on the outside take the responsibility of providing literature to institutional groups when possible, in line with the tradition of self-support.
3. That immediate sponsorship of the outgoing patient or inmate is of major importance in carrying the message to institutions.
4. That where no such committees exist all states and areas consider formation of institutional committees to work in cooperation with Area Committees.
5. That a twice-yearly bulletin be prepared for hospital and prison groups, institutional committees and sponsors.
6. That a questionnaire concerning membership, self-support, etc., be sent to institutional groups, and that such groups be encouraged to handle their own activities when possible, with outside help provided by A.A.'s when necessary.
7. That an expression of gratitude be extended to all nonalcoholic institutional personnel.
8. Elected Bud R., Southern Florida, Chairman.

Area Highlights

ALABAMA — A.A. is growing in Alabama-Northwest Florida. There are a lot of young faces, but we are losing contact with our oldtimers, which means we also lose a great deal of knowledge and experience. This has been discussed at Area, Assembly and group meetings, but as yet no one has come up with a solution. A number of Public Information Committees have been formed and they are doing a tremendous job. —John R.

ARKANSAS — A fully staffed ward is maintained at the state hospital to which patients are accepted on their own admission as alcoholics, or by court order. Counselors are recovered alcoholics and A.A. meetings are held regularly. The discharged patient has the option of entering one of several rehab dormitories over the state, where he is assigned a sponsor, required to read the Big Book and contact other A.A.'s for 28 days. —Max H.

BRITISH COLUMBIA-YUKON — A Public Information Committee is operating in our metropolitan area with very good results. It has traveled to various centers and held public meetings which attracted a lot of interest. We also had a radio broadcast for 13 weeks. It was made up of a panel of three A.A. members who answered questions phoned in by the listening public. The radio program has been followed by a TV flash which directs alcoholics to A.A. —Al H.

CALIFORNIA — (Northern Coastal) — Membership is increasing so rapidly in this Area that there is an apparent trend toward less individual sponsorship. Although there is also an apparent lack of unity, this condition will surely be relieved as more and more area meetings and get-togethers are held. Things are improving, but there are times when it seems as though an understanding of our primary purpose as well as understanding of the necessity for worldwide growth is sadly lacking. —Pat S.

CALIFORNIA — (Southern) — Newcomers in my Area are encouraged to attend as many meetings as possible and then to select a sponsor of their own choice. Our Institutions Committee has not had as good success as it might with "release sponsorship". Policy is that although it is vital to have meetings in institutions, it is equally vital that institutional members make outside contacts on their own and that such contact will lead to personal selection of a sponsor. —Jack O.

COLORADO — Our institutional sponsorship has improved tremendously. Recently a 30-minute documentary TV show was produced with A.A. help. All actors were prison inmates and members of the A.A. group. It was called "Road to Nowhere" and received extensive coverage in the western states. It is available elsewhere. G.S.R.'s from four major prisons attend state and regional conferences, with an attendant. —Ray G.

CONNECTICUT — There are no well-defined guidelines as to what sponsorship specifically is. From teachings of others in A.A. I have interpreted it to mean "anything which in any way, at any time, will help or contribute toward helping another in obtaining and/or maintaining sobriety." It is gratitude in action. It can express itself in as many ways as there are people capable of giving of themselves. —Ed S.

D.C. — There are three weekly luncheon meetings for men in the area where up to 50 A.A.'s gather for social, business and personal reasons. At the same time it has everything to do with A.A. It is an easy and casual way to bring one of the business or government types to A.A. He meets a happy attractive group discussing baseball, business and booze. At the same time he is being lined up with a sponsor, and if he is at all interested he is invited to meetings in such a way that he finds it hard to refuse. —Ernest R.

FLORIDA — (Southern) — Sponsorship is one of the missing links of service work in A.A. today. We are losing a lot of people for lack of sponsorship. They are brought to a meeting once or twice, then turned loose to scramble for themselves. We need to express what sponsorship means in the groups. It should be a number one topic at all meetings. Group sponsorship also needs to be explained at meetings. —Bud R.

FLORIDA — (Northern) — Sponsorship covers a wide field, but at all levels involves the sharing of our experience, strength and hope with others. Anything that helps the alcoholic identify, awakes motivation within him to adopt a new way of life and helps him maintain sobriety comes under the heading of sponsorship. Requirements are love and compassion, sympathetic understanding, patience, a sense of responsibility, open mind and availability. —Harry G.

HAWAII — If you visit Hawaii, dial Central — the Central Office of A.A., that is. If you want, we will be happy to arrange for someone to pick you up at your hotel, usher you to your first meeting and give you the complete Aloha A.A. treatment for the duration of your stay. Because Hawaii is a top vacation area, we receive many visitors from every part of the world. Our Aloha brand of A.A. has made the difference for many. —Wayne W.

ILLINOIS — (Chicago) — Liaison is maintained with all state hospitals and institutions, as well as with the clergy of all denominations. Help for the suffering alcoholic is available through communication between the Metropolitan and Intergroup Offices with the local groups, and three 24-hour answering services. Several hospitals treat alcoholic patients, and one has just added a \$1,000,000 facility for alcoholics. —Harry V.

ILLINOIS — (Southern) — Groups in our Area became stronger after G.S.R.'s and the Area Committeemen discussed current problems and went back to the groups with their findings. There were group inventories after which the improvements started. Now there are meetings at the hospital. Patients are taken to home town meetings and made to feel welcome. They are picked up upon release. A telephone answering service is operating and an area beginners' meeting is held weekly. —Roy S.

INDIANA — (Northern) — A.A. has formed a group at the large hospital which has accepted alcoholics for treatment in our area. The group had a regular meeting which was transferred to the hospital with the mutual consent of the members, the doctors and hospital authorities. The doctors have decided that every patient will be asked and taken to an A.A. meeting prior to release so that he can meet a few members and learn about the program. —Bob E.

IOWA — As we know from our Twelfth Step we are to carry the message. The most important and rewarding way to do this is through sponsorship. There seems to be a little different approach with each man or woman. I think that each of us must decide how we can be the most effective in dealing with another drunk. We don't have the power to wave a wand and sober up the world. We can only do our best in line with our own abilities and opportunities. —John G.

LOUISIANA — Sponsorship is most important. Working with newcomers keeps me mindful of where I came from and grateful for this new way of life. Newcomers keep me searching for more of what I have already found, so that I may be able to do a better job of staying sober and sharing with others. Through this I have found a better understanding of the Twelve Steps and Traditions, as well as the importance of unity. —Bill W.

Area Highlights

MASSACHUSETTS — (Eastern) — Institutions are sponsored by about 40% of the groups in our Area. Groups cover one institution for a month, bringing regular weekly meetings and supplying literature. These same groups also sponsor closed meetings at the institutions on other nights. This gives members closer and more personal contact in sponsoring patients and inmates. When patients are released they are guided by the same groups responsible for their meetings.
—May C.

MICHIGAN — (Central) — Sponsorship is the backbone of A.A. It not only means life or death for the new man, but for the group as well. True sponsorship mirrors our second Legacy, Unity. Unity is A.A. responsibility at group level — to the new man, regulars, oldtimers and the outside world as well. Sponsorship is a "We" undertaking. It means sharing group experience, making new people welcome, having interesting attractive meetings, being good listeners, identifying with A.A. activities and supporting G.S.O.
—Robert B.

MICHIGAN — (Southeastern) — A.A. has taken great strides in strengthening sponsorship through hospitals, prisons, mental institutions, parole sponsorship and the Michigan State Police A.A. program. In the latter program, A.A. members contact each of the 56 State Police posts to see that they have literature and to attend meetings for the troopers. A.A. literature and a letter from the director of State Police are given to all who are taken into custody because of alcohol. Results so far have been gratifying.
—Andy P.

MINNESOTA — (Southern) — New programs in Minnesota courts are inspired by prior Conference emphasis upon communications and have done much to strengthen sponsorship. Almost all courts have an A.A. friend on hand. We are reaching young people who have not gone all the way. In one case we have an informal counseling system for teenagers who receive suspended sentences if they go to courthouse meetings.
—James F.

MISSOURI — (Eastern) — Sponsorship is the most vital part of A.A. It is the bridge by which a sick alcoholic can get back to believing in himself and gaining hope enough to want to go on living. It is the way by which one human being can help another to pass through a very dangerous period of time. Sponsorship is the idea of helping without ruling, bossing or interfering.
—Al G.

MISSOURI — (Western) — Our first institutional group is the 23-year-old New Hope Group at the Federal Penitentiary, Leavenworth, Kansas. Meetings are on Sunday mornings with inmate speakers first, followed by outside speakers. At last year's anniversary wives of outside members were allowed to attend. Directors were so pleased with this boost to inside members' morale that wives were allowed to attend the Christmas party of the New Hope Group.
—Verne S.

NEVADA — In A.A. today there is a feeling that a new person, after a sufficient length of time and with proper explanation of what a sponsor is, should be allowed to choose for himself. The person who makes the first call may not be the right person. Usually the relationship is one of long and close association, resulting in enduring respect one for the other. Therefore the placing and acceptance of this responsibility should not be taken lightly.
—Les E.

NEW JERSEY — (Northern) — Area Committeemen and G.S.R.'s of my Area are a most enthusiastic and meaningful group with the aim of educating groups as to what General Service is, what General Service does on the local, national and international levels, to promote the use of G.S.O. literature, and above all to ensure that by our personal effort we make certain that on a

greatly expanded scene a healthy flourishing General Service operation is available to help those who will come along in the future.
—Jamie D.

NEW YORK — (Central) — Beyond the group level we continue to have Intergroup meetings in at least four districts. Intergroup activities include coordinating telephone answering, public information and institutional meetings. Most of our Intergroups have an open meeting with the business meeting. Intergroups function with as few as five groups. We support an Area Conference in the spring, the State Conference in the summer and a roundup in the fall.
—Steve P.

NEW YORK — (Southeastern) — There are about 250 groups in our Area and new ones starting all the time. Sponsorship is a very important thing. New groups are helped and sponsored by others. Since there is a very large A.A. membership within a rather small geographical area we are able to welcome new members at almost every meeting. With a strong Intergroup Association we are working hand in hand to help the next person through the door each 24 hours.
—Tom M.

NORTH CAROLINA — For the past two years our State Committee has sponsored our annual State Convention. Attendance has grown from 500 in past years to 1,000 in 1966. This year we expect 1,100 to 1,200 members. We attribute our success to free registration and a central location. Groups contribute on a voluntary basis to a convention fund. This has covered our expenses for the past two years.
—Dave C.

NOVA SCOTIA-NEWFOUNDLAND-LABRADOR — Sponsorship plays an important role in our groups and we have fine cooperation with medical, government, religious and law enforcement agencies. In the Sydney (N.S.) area we have two hospital groups, a prison group, and a workshop that looks after public meetings. We carry the message to nursing classes, church groups, young people's groups and help in hospital work by providing sitters on a 24-hour basis.
—Bill U.

OHIO — (Central and Southeast) — Sponsorship is one of the most important responsibilities of an alcoholic, a must if we wish to live a happy sober life. There is a lot of hope in this program, a lot of love and a lot of understanding. We cannot fail if we are always willing to hold firmly to God with one hand and to a fellow member with the other. In order to keep the program we must share.
—Fulton S.

OHIO — (Northeast) — We have one group in our Area which undertakes sponsorship as a group. Usually two men make the original call, then the newcomer is taken to meetings almost every night, with at least one different man every time. This seems to have real merit because the new man gets a variety of viewpoints and meets a great many people. This shows that there are as many ways of sponsorship in A.A. as there are members.
—Joseph S.

OKLAHOMA — Sponsorship in our group is constant fellowship for each new member for at least one year. We explain and present the Twelve Steps for his use, show him how the Twelve Traditions guide group operations, as well as the Third Legacy covering his responsibility of service. We feel that all this prepares the new member to carry the message and sponsor a newer member.
—Woody W.

ONTARIO — (Eastern) — Sponsorship is love. Love is the basic principle of our Fellowship and love is exercised through service. Sponsorship is service to the alcoholic who still suffers and who is asking for help. My responsibility lies in extending

Area Highlights

my hand to anyone, anywhere, who reaches out for help. Whether this is sponsorship or not, it is where sponsorship begins. None of us would be here had not someone taken the responsibility to extend the hand of sponsorship to us.

—Peter W.

ONTARIO — (Northeastern) — Sponsorship is an opportunity for the older, more experienced member to share his hope and strength with a newcomer. By so doing he strengthens his own sobriety. Sponsorship means a continuing interest in the alcoholic who wants help, showing him how to adjust to life without alcohol. The ability and desire to help another alcoholic through sponsorship is one of the most rewarding experiences A.A. has to offer.

—Bob McC.

ONTARIO — (Northwestern) — We are having a full three-day conference for the first time this year, with attendance expected to hit from 500 to 600, including visitors from outside the Area. At the same time we will be holding a meeting for Committeemen and G.S.R.'s for selection of an alternate Delegate as well as other business. There are approximately 18 groups in the area, four Committeemen and 16 G.S.R.'s covering an area of at least 220,000 square miles.

—Vern C.

PENNSYLVANIA — (Eastern) — Five years ago a Group Sponsorship Committee was formed at Parkside Group. Its functions are to greet new members, obtain addresses and phone numbers, make home visits, remind older members to contact newcomers, take them to beginners meetings and give them other support and encouragement. As a result active membership has more than tripled.

—Louis R.

PENNSYLVANIA — (Western) — The Samuel Shoemaker Pavilion is part of the State Hospital in Pittsburgh. Anyone in the state is eligible for commitment. Newly admitted patients receive thorough physical and psychiatric examination and those desiring treatment must stay at least 30 days. A.A. meetings are held five nights a week and attendance is compulsory. Local A.A. members arrange the meetings and provide sponsors for patients who have been released.

—Rose B.

TEXAS — (Northeast) — A.A. members sponsor all persons who voluntarily enter state hospitals as alcoholics. They must accompany patient on admittance and keep in contact while he is in the hospital through visits or correspondence. The patient is released to the sponsor when he leaves the hospital. He introduces the patient to A.A. and gets him started in the group. The patient knows that someone is interested.

—Lib M.

TEXAS — (Southeast) — We have been fortunate to find 10 active members who volunteered as committee members in our Area. They know the groups in their districts and are capable of getting them to work together. We plan monthly meetings of Committee members in the area and monthly meetings of G.S.R.'s in their districts. This keeps us in close contact with the groups and enables us to work together.

—Ralph M.

UTAH — We have held Joint Agency Meetings with state and non-profit organizations in the field of alcoholism four times in the past year. They have been useful in reducing friction between A.A. and other agencies through airing of specific problems and complaints on all sides. This has resulted in better understanding, as well as improved methods for helping the sick alcoholic.

—Pete S.

VIRGINIA — The opportunity of sponsoring an alcoholic is one of the finest rewards attained by an A.A. member. The ability to help another alcoholic is a significant part of the A.A. recovery program. A great reward for an A.A. sponsor is that he receives so much more than he gives. He ensures his day-to-day sobriety and becomes more comfortable with himself. For this he can be eternally grateful that his Higher Power enabled him to become a member of A.A.

—Ernest F.

WASHINGTON — As alcoholics sober in A.A., I sometimes feel that we worry about other agencies with a subconscious feeling that there is not enough work to go around. Fortunately, the A.A. approach in Washington is one of cooperation. We are as vitally concerned with the individual alcoholic as we ever were, and also manage to cooperate with other agencies. Many A.A. members work in the field of alcoholism, either as employees or volunteers.

—Ralph B.

WEST VIRGINIA — I feel that sponsorship is a duty which should be accepted with the sincere intention of giving a great deal of study to the individual in an attempt to find what will be most helpful. The sponsor should make himself available at all times until his pigeon is able to stand on his own feet. In our Area we guide newcomers until they become acquainted and overcome their nervousness.

—Sam M.

WISCONSIN — (Southern) — In the interest of unity, we have during the past few years been putting a lot of effort into an intensified G.S.R. program. We feel the G.S.R. is an important figure in the group and try to make our selections as outlined in the G.S.R. pamphlet. G.S.R.'s meet with the Area Committee four times a year and there is good communication between both groups. A monthly newsletter is published and groups are encouraged to send in information on meetings, Intergroups, and conferences, among other things.

—Robert W.

Communications Within A.A.

Inside A.A.

Presentation

In opening the Conference presentation on Communications within A.A., Hazel R., G.S.O. Staff, noted that communications is a two-way flow of words, acts and feelings — sometimes seen, sometimes unseen, but always with us in A.A.

Communications is A.A.'s healing force, she said. It involves giving and receiving, talking and listening, writing and reading.

Communications in A.A. calls for empathy and an exchange of the messages of the heart between alcoholics — sharing at depth, sharing to survive. As we grow, we learn to communicate more and more because we become aware of the rich and meaningful flow of life it brings to us.

May we always meet our responsibility to listen and talk with others, she said. May we know that only through the meaningful two-way flow of communication within A.A. will we survive.

Communication is truly a vital, healing force. Let us keep it flowing with the continued sharing of our experience, strength and hope, she concluded.

SERVICES VITAL TO A.A.

The most vital, yet the least understood group of services that A.A. has, are those that enable us to function as a whole, namely the General Service Office, A.A. World Services, The Grapevine and A.A.'s Board of Trustees. These services of A.A. can only be known through communication.

Since its beginning, communications to the A.A. groups have come through the General Service Office. And when the General Service Conference was formed a new line of communication opened up in A.A. Delegates, Committee Members and G.S.R.'s elected by the groups became part of communications within A.A.

Presently, G.S.R.'s receive mailings from G.S.O. and pass the information on to group membership. This is important if the Group is to be well informed and the group conscience is to be effectively expressed. Expression of the group conscience is channeled through the G.S.R., the Area Committee and Delegate. Thus, the G.S.R. is the key to a well-informed membership, as well as to the effective expression of group conscience.

Checking at the group level to gauge the effectiveness of communications within A.A., I asked members if their group shared the information in Box 4-5-9, if they could identify their G.S.R., Area Committee Member or Delegate. I also asked if they read the Grapevine, were kept posted on A.A. worldwide or knew anything of A.A. growth. About 50% knew nothing of our A.A. World Services. Some never heard of Bill or Dr. Bob. There was much interest, however, when the how and why of these services was explained.

Interest and support for A.A. services can be created through effective communications at the group level. The tools are available. All that remains is to put them to use. We can inform members personally of these services at District and Area gatherings and when we speak at open or closed meetings.

Only 15% of our membership subscribes to the Grapevine which reports on A.A. worldwide, comments on many phases of the recovery program and offers a forum to the entire membership. It is important that members know about Conference-approved literature and A.A. service material. When other material is sold, it

seems an admission that our literature is either not adequate or not available.

There is a challenge, then, for us to do our job well, because ours is the responsibility for an informed Fellowship at all levels. Service is the heart of A.A. and communications is its lifeline. And though I have been talking about structure and service, what I have really been talking about is communication — a better informed hand of A.A. reaching out in Sponsorship.

—Frank R., Trustee, Massachusetts.

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATIONS

The primary responsibility of G.S.O. has always been to share, and as A.A. grows, the need for more effective communication is increasing.

In order to meet this need for communication within G.S.O. and A.A. itself, the new assignment of Service Coordinator has been approved by Directors of A.A.W.S.

Some activities of this service within G.S.O. include plans for a Service Manual covering all policies and procedures, and improvements in the handling of incoming mail so that required action is taken more efficiently and Staff Members are made aware of what has been done when making their replies.

In order to improve communications within A.A., specific service tools are being studied and improvements considered. Among these:

1. The name of the *Exchange Bulletin* was changed to *Box 4-5-9* to identify it immediately with G.S.O., since it is known by its box number to many A.A.'s around the world. *Box 4-5-9* is mailed bimonthly to a mailing list of some 19,000, reporting new services, literature, trends, calendar of events and other information.
2. "A.A. Guidelines" and listings are made available upon request to give experience regarding specific service areas, including: central offices and committees; clubs; conventions; courts, public information committees, and alcoholic rehabilitation centers, among others. Listings are made available giving suppliers of medallions, banners and novelties as well as A.A. members who have tapes for sharing or exchange.
3. Eight tapes and two filmstrips are available. The newest addition is a talk by Dr. Bob in 1949 — his last message at the Cleveland Convention in 1950. The other side carries a talk by Sister Ignatia and comments by Bill concerning the work of both Dr. Bob and Sister Ignatia.
4. Literature order blanks are updated and mailed to all groups at least once a year. Also available are order blanks listing literature in foreign languages.
5. All new groups are now receiving a Group Handbook and complimentary literature. The Group Handbook is also available to all groups for purchase. Its contents include helpful pamphlets, suggestions concerning literature, public information, record information, order forms and A.A. Guidelines.

—Hazel R., G.S.O. Staff,
Service Coordinator

G.S.O. STAFF ACTIVITIES

Report

Group correspondence and service to groups are the major considerations of Staff Members' assignments. Correspondence is most important in providing the exchange of experiences.

To expedite correspondence and define responsibilities, each Staff Member handles specific assignments, such as Public Information, Institutions or Overseas as well as correspondence within a specified geographic area. We try to answer all letters promptly, share experience, offer suggestions and seek further ways to share.

With our mailing list now over 19,000 worldwide, sizeable correspondence is involved for our seven Staff Members.

In addition, each Staff Member receives and evaluates the many newsletters, assembly minutes and other publications from General Service Committees, Central Offices, other organizations, hospitals and overseas areas which fall within her assignment.

From these we frequently gain information that has not appeared in correspondence. Thus all such material is read carefully and also circulated weekly to all Staff Members.

Correspondence includes everything from letters from alcoholics seeking help and Lone Members trying to stay sober, to new groups seeking help and old groups seeking guidance on problems.

During the past year, Staff Members participated in 38 Regional conferences and Roundups throughout the United States and Canada. This is one of the most interesting of Staff activities, since it provides an opportunity to meet and visit with A.A.'s everywhere.

Staff Members also welcomed more than 700 visitors to G.S.O. from many countries of the world as well as the United States and Canada. They bring vividly to us the assurance that the hand of A.A. has reached far and wide.

In order to share experience with each other, Staff Members convene weekly to report on trips, trends in correspondence and to evaluate needs for procedures and service guidelines.

Each Staff Member also serves as a Secretary of committees and attends quarterly and bimonthly meetings. She is responsible for minutes, reports and agendas.

Central Offices are an important link of service, and as each new office is registered it is put on the regular mailing list. Our aim is not only to provide guidelines, but to help them become a part of the General Service structure and establish better lines of communication.

—Eve M., G.S.O. Staff,
Staff Coordinator

LONERS AT SEA

Internationalists are really Loners at sea instead of ashore. There are some 340 sea-going A.A.'s who are members of this group which carries the A.A. message around the world. Home ports as well as the ports-of-call of its members cover the globe.

Their "meeting list" and A.A. phone book is the *World Directory* — an indispensable tool in their own sobriety, and in helping them carry the message. We also provide a list of names and mailing addresses of other Internationalists. The International-

ists *Round Robin*, is published six times a year. It gives news items of interest to the men and shares the experience, strength and hope of other Internationalists as expressed in the mail we receive at G.S.O.

Box 4-5-9 goes to them bimonthly, alternating with the *Round Robin*. Thus, they receive one G.S.O. publication every month. All members are invited to correspond with the Staff Member assigned to the Internationalists and many accept this invitation. We receive about 25 letters a month from Internationalists.

The Internationalists Group was born in 1948 when an A.A. member who was also a ship's captain left copies of the "Big Book" in three Far East ports. The book carried the message to other sea-farers, adding other links to the chain. The process is still going strong.

The Internationalists are great Twelfth-Steppers, aboard ship as well as ashore; and in the last year, even over the air. One of our enterprising members has started a ham radio group. He now has about ten members scattered around the globe. We recently had a combined telephone-ham radio conversation with three of them which lasted for about twenty minutes.

There are many examples of Internationalist correspondence, including one in which a member noted: "At the bottom of your stationery, there are a few words which say 'I am responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible.' I don't know who wrote that, but you can tell them for me that the hand of A.A. reached all the way to Madras, India."

A member from New York also noted: "Even in a city like New York, with thousands of A.A. members and hundreds of meetings each week, an A.A. can get lonely. I correct this by getting a copy of the A.A. *Loners Meeting* and the Internationalists' *Round Robin*, and before you know it, I am reading letters from Peru, Viet Nam, Australia, and India. These newsletters make me feel good about my A.A. friends in all these places. I have never met any of them, but they do one whale of a Twelfth-Step job on me."

—Cora Louise B., G.S.O. Staff,
Internationalists.

Ask-It-Basket

There were a number of heartening answers and a good deal of thoughtful discussion on a question submitted to the Conference as to how Negro alcoholics could best be helped. The Delegate from Alabama said that there is an integrated group in his state that works very well and others pointed out that the only requirement in their groups for membership is a desire to stop drinking.

Louis R., Delegate from Eastern Pennsylvania, cited his own group as one, guided by the preamble, which works with the alcoholic, regardless of color and said the best answer for giving help to an alcoholic is to direct him to the group nearest and most convenient to him.

"Carrying the message is the primary thing," Louis said and the most important thing as far as Negroes are concerned is the fact that the A.A. member will answer any call regardless of race. Treat the new Negro member as an alcoholic, help him follow the program and measure his success by the quality of his sobriety. Louis also noted that no matter what the racial makeup of the group, it is best to refer to it simply as an A.A. group. Many think of an Interracial group as all Negro, and many groups which start out with both white and Negro members as "Interracial" groups do, in fact, often become all Negro.

A.A. Message Carried Home By Conference Delegates

Inside A.A.

Report

Following the 16th General Service Conference, one Delegate wrote: "The spirit of the Conference and the dedication to the principles of A.A. by all present will strengthen my desire to carry the message of A.A. in the weeks and years to come. With the help of God, I pray that I may be able to show my gratitude for my personal sobriety."

This attitude has extended to all Delegates, Chairmen and Committee Members as they carry the message of service in each Area and strengthen the lines of communication between their members, the General Service Board, G.S.O. and the Grapevine.

There are 89 Delegates from every state and province in North America meeting at the 17th General Service Conference, along with Trustees of the General Service Board, A.A. World Service, Grapevine Directors, and Staff Members of G.S.O. and the Grapevine.

These 89 Delegates are assisted by 962 Area Committee Members. During the year committees have met with Delegates and G.S.R.'s to go over the 1967 Conference Agenda and take some items back to groups for discussion. Thus many Delegates have had an expression of the thinking of their groups on agenda subjects.

Mail from the General Service Office going to G.S.R.'s in each group is resulting in a growing interest in all service matters within A.A. groups.

Several Areas have initiated their first state or local convention during the past year and one state has opened a state General Service Office to coordinate service activities and serve as a focal point for communication within the state.

Several General Service Committees regularly publish newsletters and bulletins for distribution within their Area. This not only helps keep the membership informed on service matters, but sparks the interest of G.S.R.'s in Assembly and District meetings.

As the work and influence of Area General Service Committees spread, many have formed Public Information and Institutions Committees to specialize in these activities.

State, provincial and Area conferences and conventions are a growing adjunct to the "A.A. Way of Life," providing not only the fellowship of an A.A. gathering, but the means of sharing in service, since Delegates' reports, sharing sessions and workshops become a vital part of these occasions.

—Midge M., G.S.O. Staff,
Conference Secretary

A.A.W.S. ACTIVITIES GROW

A.A. World Services, Inc., is a membership corporation responsible for: (1) employment of G.S.O. personnel, (2) preparing and controlling the operating budget, and (3) publishing and distributing all Conference-approved books and pamphlets.

G.S.O.'s administrative group is made up of the Chairman of General Services, the Controller, Staff Members and Department Supervisors. There are 43 full- and 3 part-time employees exclusive of Grapevine personnel.

Some highlights of A.A.W.S. operations in the past year:

PUBLISHING: Distribution of A.A. literature increased substantially over 1965. Sales of books and pamphlets were up 14.6%. After paying its own share of overhead, the publishing operation contributed \$48,000 in support of other services.

In 1966, A.A.W.S. authorized free distribution of 114,600 pieces of literature with an actual cost of \$3,801 plus shipping costs. The practice of pricing foreign language literature to meet the needs of low economy countries was continued.

SHIPPING: Another new peak in shipping department activity was reached. Al Cryan, assisted by 10 full- and part-time employees, was kept busy handling 51,537 incoming mail items and sending out 209,400 items. Maintenance of more than 17,000 addressograph plates is part of shipping department work, as is mimeographing, which involved more than 850,000 copies during 1965.

ARCHIVES: Nell Wing has the dual job of being Bill's secretary and also Archivist. Her files spin the history of our growing movement. Staff, groups and individual A.A.'s call on Nell for information. She keeps track of countless items; books and pamphlets, letters, tapes and films.

STENO/CLERICAL: Kleina Jones has fifteen girls in her department. Eight transcribers, including two translators, took care of more than 25,000 dictated letters last year. In addition, they answered 2,500 "non-dictated" letters regarding orders, film routing, etc., as part of a new service to relieve Staff Members.

ACCOUNTING: This department has four girls supervised by Dennis Manders and his assistant, Charles Columbia. They do a number of things related to G.S.O.'s money — keep the general books, build and control the budget, maintain operating statistics, processes and records. During 1966, 16,500 contributions were received and recorded and 12,400 orders were processed for shipment, a 20% increase over 1965.

RECORDS: Under supervisor Rose Failla, this department set a new high in establishing records for new groups and in handling changes on close to a current basis. This year the department took over the responsibility of keeping Dennis' group statements accurate as to addresses, so that quarterly statements would not go astray.

—Herb M., Chairman,
A.A. World Services, Inc.

AGENDA - ADMISSIONS

Conference Action

The Agenda-Admissions Committee of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That the following subjects be considered for next year's agenda: how we can make A.A. more attractive to young people; duties and responsibilities of Committee members; keeping oldtimers active; "Fellowship — the Spirit of A.A." as possible theme; sharing A.A. inside and outside the Fellowship; keeping the faith; service to A.A. — what it means; and "my personal obligation outside A.A."
2. That a review be made of Third Legacy electoral procedures.
3. That more emphasis be placed upon workshops and that we explore the possibility of breaking up into smaller groups after presentations. Also that a fresh look be taken at the method of forming workshops, using Area size and population as criteria rather than region.
4. That Delegates send agenda recommendations to G.S.O. before October.
5. Elected Jack O., Southern California, Chairman.

Making a Conference Report Groups Will Want To Hear

Presentation

A Conference Report to G.S.R.'s and the groups should consist of what we see, hear and feel at this Conference, without being too long-winded. Such a

report is generally well received, and members will often ask for extra copies.

In New Mexico, where distances between towns are great, it seems best to make reports to Intergroup meetings when possible. Last year I gave my report to five out of seven Areas into which our state is divided. It is best when the report is given as part of a regular meeting. The normal A.A. talks add to attendance.

I think it best to cover as much of the Conference as possible to give a picture of overall A.A. It would be a mistake, I feel, to emphasize just one point, the affairs of the committee upon which I serve, for instance.

The object of the report should be to carry the message of worldwide A.A. to groups which tend to become wrapped up in their own affairs, forgetting that if it were not for the State Assembly and G.S.O. the group would probably die.

From notes compiled during the Conference, it is possible to give a description of meetings with fellow Delegates, description of G.S.O. and Staff Members, as well as a summary of what happened at the Conference. For the most part it is best to stick to the facts, pointing up the harmony among Delegates.

It is also a good idea to encourage use of Box 4-5-9, to help members see A.A. as a whole and feel that they are responsible for A.A. growth, as well as to report to G.S.R.'s and groups by mail at frequent intervals.

—Bob F., New Mexico

CONFERENCE REPORT IN ACTION

When I returned to New Hampshire after the Conference last year, it was not to win a popularity contest, but to paint a true picture of the way things were.

I traveled some 4,000 miles the first six weeks. Some of the groups had never been visited by a Delegate before. I didn't point out what should be done, only what other Areas were doing. I mentioned the danger of not following Third Legacy Procedure, the lack of unity and the fact that personalities were overshadowing principles.

I also pointed out that although New Hampshire had one of the biggest alcoholic populations, we were one of the slowest growing in A.A. population, that the hand of A.A. was not always there when people reached out.

I spoke of the dedication and service I had witnessed at the Conference and made suggestions to anyone who would spare me a moment. I talked Service, Unity, G.S.O. and State Assembly. If I wasn't asked, I requested time to speak, always keeping it short and sincere, pointing up the need for unity and better communications.

As a result more new groups were started in New Hampshire last year than ever before. The Assembly has monthly dinner

meetings attended by a majority of groups. The Third Legacy has been adapted into a set of procedures we can use as a foundation from which to grow.

We have also formed Institutional, P.I. and Convention Committees. The Assembly supplies free literature to institutions. We hold monthly sharing sessions and workshops, put out a monthly bulletin to improve group communication and have just installed our first telephone with 24-hour answering service.

We held our first state convention and planning is underway for our second. There has also been increased interest in the Conference since I presented agenda items to G.S.R.'s so they could discuss it with their groups.

—George J., New Hampshire

NEED FOR TIME AND EFFORT

First, I find it important to know the members of the State Assembly and group G.S.R.'s, to share in meetings with them. In Kentucky we have at least 10 G.S.R. meetings a year, and about six state meetings.

It is also important to get G.S.R.'s to talk to their groups about G.S.O., about A.A. literature, the Grapevine, how the Staff works for the Fellowship.

The Delegate should ask to be invited to the groups to make his report, then see that announcements are made before the event. If there are not many groups, districts can combine for Conference Report meetings. Visit all Areas and give as much of your service to the small group as to the large.

Another method is to invite groups to attend special Area meetings where there will be questions and answers about G.S.O. Invite two or three past Delegates. Try to have these meetings often and in different districts.

It may be that we are at fault when groups don't want to hear about G.S.O. We have the tools, but we don't take the time and effort to share what we have with others. If we try to do a little extra it may be that we can help even more to carry the message of recovery in our Areas.

—Bernie S., Kentucky

BOX 4-5-9 AIDS DELEGATES

Interview Time

Have you been able to use the "Town Crier" and "GSR Corner" now carried in Box 4-5-9? Some of the answers provided by Delegates to this question:

1. Box 4-5-9 read more by the groups with the new material.

2. Bulletin used at G.S.R. meetings and Assemblies.

3. Marked items read to groups.

4. Put out newsletter, using some items from 4-5-9.

5. Devoted entire meeting of G.S.R.'s to new format.

6. Helpful to G.S.R.'s in educating group.

7. One group uses at each meeting to get G.S.R. known.

G.S.B. Okays Increase To 21

Inside A.A.

Report

The Board welcomed a new General Service Trustee, Robert H., who is also a member of A.A.W.S.

At the quarterly meeting in April, the Board voted unanimously to accept the advisory actions of the Conference. Some of them were:

1. That the Board be increased to 21, seven nonalcoholic and 14 alcoholic. Of the latter, eight shall be Regional and six shall be General Service Trustees. Class A Trusteeship shall follow a rotation plan for 3-3-3 years. The Board shall incorporate Bylaw changes to provide for additional Trustees and for Class A rotation (timed so no present Class A be affected).
2. That there be an International Convention in Miami July 3-5, 1970.
3. That communications be strengthened between Central Offices and G.S.O. activities, coordinated by a Staff Member. Also that a bulletin be initiated.
4. To reaffirm present policy on World Directory listings, continuing the policy of "No Commercial Use."

Other recommendations approved by the Board at regular quarterly meetings in July, October and January included:

1. Adopted resolution changing G.S.B. Bylaws in keeping with 1966 Conference action.

2. That a 1970 Convention Guarantee Fund be established.
3. Election of Robert Morse as Treasurer.
4. Approved \$1,000 loan to German Literature Committee.
5. Approved position paper on relations with clubhouses and rehabilitation centers, and guidelines for separation of A.A. and Al-Anon groups.
6. Acted to insure separation of A.A. from non-A.A. matters by establishing a procedure whereby all inquiries pertaining to B-3 and niacin are referred directly to an office in Pleasantville, N.Y. In order that Bill's personal interest in these items not involve the Fellowship, the Board requested that Bill's stationery (used in such correspondence) carry an address other than G.S.O.'s and that no G.S.O. employee be involved.
7. Approved a suggestion that we try to improve our communications and reach out more effectively to those who are reaching out to us.
8. Approved a resolution by Dr. Norris expressing appreciation to all Grapevine staff and volunteers for their work in converting an accumulated deficit of \$41,000 in 1959 to a total surplus and surplus reserve of \$46,000 at the end of 1966, as well as grateful acknowledgment of the \$5,000 dividend paid into the General Fund. The Board assured that it will advance funds in the future should the Grapevine be in financial need.—John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman General Service Board

Retain 2-Year Delegate Term

Conference Action

Following presentations pro and con by two Delegates and discussion by others, members of the 17th General Service Conference voted overwhelmingly to continue the two-year term for Delegates to the Conference. The pro and

con presentations follow:

SEES NEED FOR EXTRA YEAR

Presentation

Leading off the discussion on a possible three-year term for Delegates, Grover S., Delegate from Delaware, said that the reason many Delegates did not favor a change was because of the confusion as to how it would work. If a change were voted, however, effective means would be found to carry it out, he stated.

Noting that new Delegates were overwhelmed with the business and scope of the Conference, that no one should be expected to walk in cold and hope to assimilate all that was going on, he said that a rather simple answer to the problem is a three-year term . . . or longer.

This, would permit new Delegates to devote their first year to the acquisition of background information. In the second year, Delegates would have their feet firmly planted on the ground, able to offer constructive criticism and valuable experience. Hopefully, third-year Delegates would be more mature, offering real hope and inspiration as do the oldtimers in A.A.

Lest it be argued that adoption of a three-year term would deny other A.A.'s the right to serve, it should be remembered that

Trustees are elected for four years, he said. "I have never heard it mentioned that other good A.A.'s are being denied their rights because of the length of Trustees' terms. Why should the argument be allowed for Delegates," he concluded.

TWO YEARS ENOUGH

After giving "considerable thought and consideration" to the question of a three-year term for Delegates, Marty C., Delegate from South Dakota, urged that the two-year term be continued.

He noted that in his state there is an abundance of sober men and women who are competent and qualified in every way. "They could and would do an excellent job as Delegate, were they to have this opportunity," he said, noting that the knowledge that "so many will never have their chance to serve is a matter of deep concern and regret."

"It does not seem to be the better part of wisdom to lessen rather than to increase the chances of this host of qualified members to serve their Fellowship," he said.

The Board and G.S.O. give stability and know-how, he said, pointing out that the Delegates express the thinking of A.A. and do not have a "corner" on the ability, resourcefulness and enthusiasm necessary to serve properly.

"We should be able to step aside after two years and lend our encouragement and knowledge to those enthusiastic, capable and dedicated persons to follow who will stimulate the entire Fellowship by their presence and actions even as you and I hope we may have done," he concluded.

New Sponsorship Tools

Report

In 1966-67 the Literature Committee of the Board proceeded with preparation and publication of:

1. A new hard-cover book of selections from Bill's writings, including much previously unpublished material, called "The A.A. Way of Life."
2. A comic-book-style pamphlet, designed as much for those who don't like to read as for those who don't read well or for whom English is a second language.
3. A new pamphlet, "Newcomers' Meetings" has been circulated and is undergoing minor revisions before publication.

The committee authorized revisions of three pamphlets: "A.A. For the Woman"; "Young People and A.A."; and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship." It is expected that ideas for the Sponsorship pamphlet will be provided by this year's Conference theme, "Sponsorship — the Hand of A.A."

In response to suggested preparation of a pamphlet for nurses, the committee recommended that Public Information prepare a mimeographed piece incorporating a talk given by a nurse and former G.S.O. Staff Member before the American Nurses' Convention in 1964.

The committee also discussed the number of pamphlets now available. It concluded that none should be dropped, since many thousands of each are distributed annually. However, no new pamphlets should be authorized unless there is a strongly felt need.

The year 1966 was very good for literature distribution: The "Big Book" showed an increase of 16%; "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," an increase of 6%; "A.A. Comes of Age," Foreign literature increased 38% due to the growth of A.A. overseas.

—Austin MacCormick, Chairman,
General Service Board Literature Committee

THE 'A.A. WAY OF LIFE'

One of the most exciting events of the past year has involved our new book, "The A.A. Way of Life." It explained to me what had happened to me when I first came to A.A.

My first A.A. meeting was the beginning of a spiritual awakening, but because I didn't recognize it, it seemed more like spiritual death. This was explained to me in our new book where Bill says:

"Years ago I used to commiserate with all people who suffered. Now I commiserate only with those who suffer in ignorance; who do not understand the purpose and ultimate utility of pain . . . A.A. is no success story in the ordinary sense of the word. It is a story of suffering transmuted, under Grace, into spiritual progress."

Here was Bill, talking to me, explaining how it had been with me. Just as I found my page, so will every A.A. find his. All the right pages are there in "The A.A. Way of Life," waiting for the right person to find them.

Between the covers of this book is our program — excerpts from the "Big Book," "Twelve and Twelve," "A.A. Comes of Age," the Grapevine. There is new material from letters and talks, expanding and explaining our way.

If you are a great reader, there are 332 pages of words and thoughts and ideas to devour and digest — short pieces covering

Literature

all the attitudes and states of mind from "Acceptance" to "Worry," with a handy reference guide to lead you there quickly.

As you can see, our new book has provided me with a brand new A.A. experience. The message I get is that "The A.A. Way of Life" can, as Bill says, lead us on to that clear recognition of what and who we really are, followed by a sincere attempt to become what we can be, both as individual A.A. members and as a Fellowship.

On page 90, Bill says, "Life takes on new meaning in A.A. To watch people recover, to see them help others, to watch loneliness vanish, to see a fellowship grow up about you, to have a host of friends — this is an experience not to be missed."

All of us feel this, I know, but Bill seems to say it better than anyone else. And he is presenting all of us with the opportunity to share 332 pages of "The A.A. Way of Life" — an experience, I believe, not to be missed. —Cora Louise B., G.S.O. Staff

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED — 1966

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	34,948
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition) . .	11,611
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition) . .	3,895
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	3,825
30th Anniversary Book — A.A./30	1,105
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish Edition	897
Total	56,281

PAMPHLETS

The A.A. Group	28,538
This Is A.A.	131,159
44 Questions & Answers	104,286
Is A.A. For You?	147,787
Young People in A.A.	47,917
A.A. for the Woman	48,400
A.A. Tradition	16,988
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship	30,445
Alcoholism the Illness	60,554
The Alcoholic Husband	71,345
The Alcoholic Wife	44,875
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	18,113
A.A. and the Medical Profession	28,348
Sedatives, Stimulants & the Alcoholic	62,188
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	42,440
Fortune Reprint	26,351
Good Housekeeping Reprint	36,807
Inside A.A.	21,698
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	27,912
Fellowship of A.A.	51,299
Memo to an Inmate	26,581
A.A. in Prisons	14,134
G.S.R. Folder	20,893
You, Your Group and A.A.	16,253
A.A. in Hospitals	15,955
A.A. in Your Community (new)	73,397
Foreign Translations	44,171
The Third Legacy Manual & Twelve Concepts . . .	3,669
Total	1,262,503

MISCELLANEOUS

Tapes of A.A. Talks	309
Wallet Cards — 2 Fold	233,323
Wallet Cards — "I Am Responsible"	40,086
Parchment Scrolls	1,978
How It Works	59,896

COMIC-BOOK PAMPHLET ISSUED

Presentation

pieces of literature.

It was designed for people who either can't read very well or don't want to read. As it turns out, I feel that it will reach people who read at any level — doctors, lawyers, and blue collar workers — and who want to find out about A.A. quickly and easily.

I gave it to all the people in my group and asked for their opinion, as well as to nonalcoholics. As a final test I passed it out to a group of Boy Scouts who meet regularly in my home. I found a few minutes later that they had acquired as much knowledge of what A.A. is and is about as many of the people I know in the program.

I feel that "What Happened to Joe" covers A.A. as completely as many pieces of literature that use many more words, that it can be used in many areas to acquaint professional people and interested nonalcoholics in A.A., as well as the suffering alcoholic and his family.

—Jim M., Trustee

I feel that "What Happened to Joe," A.A.'s new piece of service literature in comic-book form, has the potential of becoming one of our most important

APPROVE NEW LITERATURE

Conference Action

The Literature Committee of the General Service Conference took the following actions:

1. Reported that "The A.A. Way of Life" is anticipated with great interest in all areas; noted enthusiastic reception of comic-book pamphlet, "What Happened to Joe"; voiced high hopes for "Newcomers Meeting Kit," and expressed interest in upcoming revisions of "A.A. For the Woman," "Young People in A.A.," and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."
2. Suggested that Area Committees interest groups in Conference-approved literature by using "Let literature carry the message, too" as an agenda item at Area meetings and holding discussions on specific pamphlets at sharing sessions and workshops.
3. Recommended to the Trustees' Literature Committee that the possibility of translating "What Happened to Joe" into Spanish be explored and that it ask permission of the Grapevine to reprint Bill's article "Problems other than Alcohol" for use as a pamphlet.
4. Elected Louis R., Eastern Pennsylvania, Chairman.

GOD AND THE NEWCOMER

Presentation

I also believe that younger members coming to A.A. for help find it difficult, since they have not been so badly hurt.

I try to assure new members that although they have heard mention of God, they should remember that we are speaking of God as we understand Him. Furthermore, I remind them that most of us in our early days didn't have any understanding. The thing to do is try to relax and concentrate on only one thing — how to stay away from that first drink one day at a time.

I tell newcomers to try their best to accept the First Step and try not to let the others bother them for the time being. Just keep coming back to meetings.

If they are bothered by the Twelfth Step I tell them that "spiritual" to me simply meant a change in my thinking which resulted in personality changes. Furthermore, this change comes about very slowly as a rule.

We, who have the privilege of working with new members, can do much more on a personal basis. It is here, I believe, that we need to recapture our enthusiasm. Belief in ourselves, our desire to help and our ability will pay off through the Grace of God, however we understand Him.

—Belle H., Quebec

* * *

Following the presentation on the spiritual message for the newcomer, Delegates made a number of additional suggestions. Among these: tell the newcomer he can't have faith and fear at the same time. If he lets go of fear, he will find faith; tell the newcomer to lean on A.A. and faith will come; tell him that he should have faith in A.A. because A.A. has faith in him; let him learn by observation, not by preaching; don't mention the spiritual part of the program until it comes up.

CENTRAL OFFICES

Interview Time

How can Central and Intergroup Offices and committees be in closer touch with General Service committees? Delegates provided a number of suggestions in answer to this question, among which were the following:

1. Have regular meetings between the Delegate and Intergroup secretary.
2. Make use of Box 4-5-9, the new Guidelines for Central Offices, and other literature.
3. Hold open meetings at which there is one speaker from the Central Office and another from the area Conference service structure.
4. Invite Central Office secretary and volunteers to attend General Service committee meetings.
5. Ask Delegate to make a report to Central Service Office meetings, and Central Service secretary make report to area committee meeting.
6. Make it clear that the General Service Committee wants to co-operate fully.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. Can a paid secretary of a Central Office hold another office in an outside agency as a volunteer in developing an interest among professionals, such as doctors, lawyers and ministers?
- A. Staff Members at G.S.O. limit their activities to G.S.O. even to the point of not acting in any official capacity in their own groups. In effect they work for all groups and this attitude precludes engaging in any work in the general field of alcoholism. This avoids confusion, particularly in the minds of people outside A.A.

Circulation at Record High

Grapevine

Report

The Grapevine's Conference Committee has worked during the past year as never before to carry awareness of the Grapevine to all groups. The result — increased subscriptions, and circulation at an all-time high of 48,000, as well as renewed interest in contributing articles and letters.

The Grapevine introduced at the 1967 Conference a new photo calendar, 1968 — *'One day at a time,'* for sale at \$1.25. The calendar is expected to be a continuing project yearly. It is inspirational in tone and not obviously tied to A.A. so that it can be posted anywhere without breaking anonymity.

The Grapevine introduced a simulated-leather binder to hold a year's supply of Grapevines. Of the original order of 1,000 — 400 have been sold at \$2.50 each. This was conceived as a service item and little net income will be realized.

Of 20,000 copies of the "Best of Bill," a packet of pamphlets printed in 1965, 1,500 remain and are being sold out. They will not be reprinted in view of the publication this year of a reader selected from Bill's writings.

The Grapevine issued a Preamble card for group use, and sent a free copy to every subscribing A.A. group as a service. Additional copies are available to groups and individuals at 25 cents each.

—Tom W., Editor

GRAPEVINE EMPHASIZES STEPS

Presentation

The Grapevine backs up one pace in the May, 1967 issue to make the point that deep participation in the Twelve Steps of the A.A. program must come before effective A.A. sponsorship can be given.

The philosophical backbone of the Grapevine — issue to issue, year to year — is the Steps and the Traditions. Our May issue begins with an article on the Twelfth Step and its promise to us of a new life if we will take *all* the Steps. This is the last in a year-long series, all of which have taken the Steps as vital needs of the A.A. way of life. Almost all our articles, in fact, point up the importance of the A.A. Steps.

Thus, most Grapevine articles fall into one of two categories:

1. Personal experience shared by the alcoholic (Twelfth Step).
2. Insights into working the program (Steps One through Eleven).

An analysis of the May, 1967 issue, for instance, shows that eight out of fourteen articles deal with various aspects of the Twelfth Step — from sponsorship to service, to spiritual awakening. One article deals with the First Step, another with the Second. There is an article on the Tenth Step and one covering both the Third and Eleventh Steps. There is also an article on the First Tradition and one on alcoholism itself.

The Grapevine is the hub of a giant Twelfth-Step network reaching from all five continents to New York and back again as each issue circulates worldwide. Hundreds upon hundreds of A.A.'s have written and sketched for the magazine — for no pay.

In New York the GV Editorial Board, twenty-one strong, meets nine times a year to guide policy, and to research and write articles.

Grapevine business is managed by a Corporate Board of nine men and women. On the Board are one non-A.A. Trustee, five A.A. volunteers from the New York area, and three staff members.

There are four regular meetings of the Board each year for review of the finances and management policies of the magazine enterprise. Innumerable smaller meetings are held regarding day to day matters.

The responsible service of the Grapevine's Corporate Board makes it possible for the editorial and business staffs to prepare a magazine for 48,000 subscribers. Through "pass-alongs" the Grapevine is read monthly by upwards of 100,000 A.A. members and their families — truly a literary Twelfth-Step call on virtually the entire Fellowship.

TWELVE-STEP CALL IN PRINT

Trustee Ed L. in introducing participants of the presentation, "Twelve Steps and the Printed Word," referred to the Grapevine as "A Twelve-Step Call in Print."

Ruth W., GV Director and Treasurer, said that in the face of rising costs the magazine is trying to curtail expenses and develop new methods of production and distribution in order to "take every possible step" before increasing the price.

Circulation Director, David B., said that with circulation at an all-time high of 48,000, the GV is continuing to encourage sales and subscriptions with wall and table posters, kits for groups and conventions and the enthusiastic help of GV representatives.

Delegate Joe C., Chairman of the Conference Grapevine Committee, urged Delegates to work out a way to get subscriptions to prisons and other institutions where inmates cannot buy copies. Since the Grapevine is a nonprofit corporation, he noted, copies can't be given away.

Barry L., Grapevine Director noted that two new sections, "Around A.A." and "About Alcoholism" had been well received. The former contains material on the Third Legacy and Service, he noted, while the latter has material regarding news of the disease. An interesting article regarding the drunkenness offender will appear in the July issue, he said.

OPINION ON GV CALENDAR

Interview Time

In your Grapevine kit you received an advance 1968 Grapevine Calendar. We hope to bring out such a calendar yearly. What do you think of this idea? Out of those Delegates responding, 66 thought this was a good idea and 14 thought it was not. In addition they offered a number of comments, among which were the following:

1. Like the pictures and think it will be well received.
2. A long-needed daily reminder.
3. Have tie-in sales with GV binders and/or Serenity Prayer.
4. Have A.A. dates on it; include international holidays such as Dominion day for Canada.
5. Even though fairly priced, seems expensive; suggest it be made known that calendar is not a profit-making item.
6. Groups might feel GV getting too much into sales field, always something new to buy. Suggest making known that there was a demand for the calendar.

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION 4-1-67

UNITED STATES

Alabama.....	367
Alaska.....	102
Arizona.....	354
Arkansas.....	341
California.....	5,116
Colorado.....	394
Connecticut.....	827
Delaware.....	154
Washington, D.C.....	279
Florida.....	1,386
Georgia.....	583
Hawaii.....	67
Idaho.....	117
Illinois.....	1,685
Indiana.....	651
Iowa.....	533
Kansas.....	626
Kentucky.....	474
Louisiana.....	494
Maine.....	319
Maryland.....	808
Massachusetts.....	2,248
Michigan.....	1,880
Minnesota.....	1,150
Mississippi.....	229
Missouri.....	788
Montana.....	251
Nebraska.....	333
Nevada.....	162
New Hampshire.....	167
New Jersey.....	1,739
New Mexico.....	313
New York.....	4,009
North Carolina.....	890
North Dakota.....	165
Ohio.....	2,023
Oklahoma.....	583
Oregon.....	412
Pennsylvania.....	1,418
Rhode Island.....	165
South Carolina.....	384
South Dakota.....	325
Tennessee.....	377
Texas.....	2,123
Utah.....	176
Vermont.....	207
Virginia.....	789
Washington.....	731
West Virginia.....	240
Wisconsin.....	747
Wyoming.....	102
Total.....	40,803

CANADA

Alberta.....	423
British Columbia.....	806
Manitoba.....	537
New Brunswick.....	216
Newfoundland.....	54
Northwest Territory.....	8
Nova Scotia.....	269
Ontario.....	2,434
Prince Edward Island.....	124
Quebec.....	436
Saskatchewan.....	409
Yukon.....	12
Total.....	5,728

United States Possessions.....	111
All Foreign.....	929

Grapevine

SUBSCRIPTIONS FOR INMATES

Conference Action

The Grapevine Committee of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That Delegates suggest to groups the need for sponsoring subscriptions to the Grapevine for prisons, jails and hospitals in their Areas.
2. That the difference in price, owing to Canadian rate of exchange with U.S. currency, be indicated on future GV order forms.
3. That the Serenity Prayer be incorporated into the GV's regular monthly format.
4. Elected Les E., Nevada, Chairman.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. Is there any indication that our basic principle of co-operation but not affiliation is being compromised at the grass roots membership level by recent court decisions, mushrooming alcoholism treatments centers and increasing state and federal funds? Would it not be advisable to re-clarify A.A.'s basic purpose, i.e. to aid individual alcoholics seeking our help, rather than become experts in the alcoholism field?
- A. G.S.O.'s new "Guidelines on Court Programs" along with "Cooperation but Not Affiliation" would be helpful here. The consensus was that an individual A.A. working in these programs can educate both the agency and A.A. when he is aware of the danger of confusing the agency with A.A., adheres to the Traditions and makes sure his agency is also aware of the Traditions. This will minimize the danger of confusing the purposes of A.A. and the other agency.
- Q. How can we help to make the World Directory more accurate? Are committee members ever consulted?
- A. The Conference asked G.S.O. to establish better contacts with G.S.R.'s and thus we are using them as group contacts. This procedure continues to improve the accuracy of our directory listing. Committee Members are asked to remind groups to return directory information cards to G.S.O. and this has also helped. It is suggested that all Delegates examine the current Directory and return any corrections to G.S.O.
- Q. Can states with more than one Area be reported by Area in the Directory? Can we have summaries by Area rather than by state?
- A. Since some Conference Areas cover parts of two states, this would defeat the purpose of the Directory which is to aid traveling members in locating specific addresses in a particular state. The Directory is regarded as an aid for traveling members and as a G.S.O. mailing list, rather than a Conference listing.

P.I.C. Activities Hit Record

Public
Information

Report

A.A.'s Sixth Annual Report to the Public was prepared in news release form and sent to local Public Information Committees who in turn contacted local media. A total of 26 stories came to our attention, a sharp improvement over previous years.

During the year your Public Information Committee also prepared an article on A.A. for "Resident Physician," a magazine directed to hospital residents and interns; participated in a taped radio show for Station WAER, Syracuse, N.Y., and a panel program for WOR Radio, New York City.

A second Public Service Announcement was prepared for Radio and TV, to be released to local P.I. Committees. The need for a second is indicated by the fact that 112 prints of the original TV announcement have been ordered and 121 prints of the radio announcement.

In its relations with other organizations, the committee is currently exploring various ways that A.A. can participate in the program of the 28th International Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism to be held in Washington, D.C., Sept. 15-20, 1968.

Members of the committee have attended meetings of the Executive Committee of the Community Council of Greater New York on Alcoholism. One featured the play, "Lady On The Rocks," and the second was a seminar attended by more than 1,000 nurses.

Representatives of P.I.C. also met with the Executive Committee of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs. Some of the points covered:

1. N.A.A.A.P. will explore the possibility of preparing a pamphlet about pills.
2. The P.I. Committee expressed A.A.'s feeling about the N.A.A.A.P. award to Dr. Bob for achievement in the field of alcoholism. N.A.A.A.P. agreed to make the award to Dr. Robert Smith for his work in the field of alcoholism without mention of his membership in A.A.

A release was sent on the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community" to the affiliates of the National Council on Alcoholism and N.A.A.A.P., as well as several schools with courses on alcoholism and to A.A. Central Offices.

—Murray W., Chairman,
G.S. Board Public Information Committee.

A.A. AND THE PROFESSIONAL

Presentation

A rather remarkable change is beginning to manifest itself in regard to the relationship between medical men, other professionals and the alcoholic.

No longer is lasting sobriety looked upon as a miracle or even as exceptional. Every year, indeed every month, a few more nurses, members of the clergy and physicians are becoming aware from irrefutable evidence that alcoholics do get sober and remain so, not because of pastoral counseling, or psychotherapy or drug treatment, but due to the quiet efficient effect of the Twelve Step program of A.A.

How do these men and women so much in need of help find their way to A.A.? Occasionally because of their own resources, or

sometimes through the good services of a friend. More and more often, however, it is because of a direct contact on the part of a nurse, a clergyman or a doctor. Let us not forget the welfare worker, or, indeed, the magistrate. These professional people are beginning to educate one another by word of mouth, by citing examples and by noting the sheer weight of the overwhelming evidence that accrues as the success of A.A. makes itself more and more apparent in the community.

Today many professional people are making use of A.A. to the degree where they are sometimes criticized as doing very little themselves and expecting the members of A.A. to do their work for them. I have learned recently, for example, that some younger psychiatrists may be criticized for sending patients to A.A. when they do not have much of a problem and do not qualify as alcoholics.

The majority of recent textbooks of medicine and psychiatry concede, somewhat reluctantly perhaps, that A.A. constitutes the best method extant for the long-term treatment of the alcoholic. Although many alcoholics accept contact with A.A., professionals are as much concerned as ever about the hard-core alcoholic who denies he has a problem and whose resistances are almost unbelievably strong.

These are the alcoholics responsible for causing many professional people to be reactionary about alcoholism. They are relatively rare but they cause so much trouble that they create an illusion that they constitute the largest group of alcoholics in the community, when the reverse is true.

A.A. members can reach disillusioned non-A.A. professionals in a number of ways. First, they can be a little kinder in their remarks about professional people. Second, they can go to the professionals of their acquaintance and tell them about their own recovery in A.A.

Lectures at medical and other professional societies by A.A. members are also invaluable, as is the encouragement of medical students and others to attend A.A. meetings. There is also a possibility that the doctor who is himself a member of A.A. might be able to do more to encourage understanding by the medical profession.

It is my opinion that an increasing number of individuals in A.A. are able to go to church, have pastoral counseling, undergo psychotherapy and other treatments with great advantage so long as they maintain that one essential to sobriety — an unremitting utilization of everything that A.A. has to offer.

—Travis Dancey, M.D., Trustee

Ask-It-Basket

Q. What is the difference between publicity and promotion?

A. It is felt that there are two points to consider. One is the objective of the publicity or idea. The second is the means by which it is to be obtained. If both the objective and the means are regulated and conform to good taste, no violation of tradition is at stake, and there is nothing to be apprehensive about. There are several techniques by which these objectives can be achieved. Guidelines for attaining them can be found in the Traditions in 1, 4, 6, 7, 10, 11, 12.

WHERE IT'S HAPPENING

The local level is "where it's happening" — in your town and your group. All Public Information Committee work focuses on the man who will walk into your meeting place. Our aim is to let him know that A.A. is there.

We try to reach this person on a country-wide basis, through national publications, TV and radio networks, syndicates, national conventions of people whose professions put them in contact with active alcoholics.

However, it is the local P.I. Committees that have the clearest close-up view of the needs and opportunities in their own Areas. Some of these committees have been active for years. Others have just swung enthusiastically into operation. They have all been learning by experience — and many of them have been sharing that experience with each other.

A number of local P.I.C.'s have been sending in reports on their activities. This has enabled us to compile a series of bulletins. These in turn have gone back to local P.I. workers so Kansas knows what Ontario is doing and vice versa.

Local P.I.C.'s not only tell about their accomplishments, but also about problems encountered. This is good, because if one committee is having trouble establishing a strong relationship with doctors, another P.I.C. a thousand miles away may provide an answer.

—Janet G., G.S. Board
Public Information Committee

COMMUNITY INFORMATION

Interview Time

Name one way in which the message of A.A. has been carried to the community in your area. Delegates provided a number of answers to this question, among which were the following:

1. Provide meetings for local ministerial association, doctors, lawyers and other professional groups.
2. Public A.A. meetings to which professional and civic leaders were invited.
3. Use of radio-TV announcements, newspaper ads, publicity, question and answer programs and providing literature to interested professionals, state and city offices.
4. Cooperation with alcoholism information centers, state commissions and other agencies which refer alcoholics to A.A.
5. Cooperation during Alcoholism Information Week.
6. Urge courses in high schools, medical schools and other educational programs.
7. Suggesting that individual members contact professional people they know who might be interested.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q.** Some A.A. members feel it is all right to break anonymity at the public level. Is this a growing trend? Should we take another look at this Tradition? Will the Conference endorse a resolution to one effect or another?
- A.** *This is not seen as a growing trend at G.S.O. and it does not seem necessary to endorse a resolution favoring the Tradition of Anonymity. Sense of the meeting was to continue procedures already in use, i.e. contacting media and members when such breaks occur and alerting media periodically about our Traditions.*

Public Information

ACCEPT POSITION PAPERS ON CLUBS, REHABS

Conference Action

The 17th General Service Conference voted to accept position papers on (1) Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers and (2) Clubs.

The paper on rehabs noted that there is no such thing as an "A.A. Rehabilitation Center," although such centers may have been identified with the Fellowship because they were organized and directed by A.A. members. It has proven practical to make it a point that they are in no way affiliated with A.A. Then they are in the clear to accept money from sources outside A.A., the position paper said. It was also suggested that the name of such an institution in no way involves A.A. or any terms identified with A.A., that meetings held there be named after the locality rather than the center. The Conference voiced recognition of the fact that rehabs are not a part of A.A. and therefore are not responsible for adhering to A.A. Traditions.

The paper on clubs noted that although there is no such thing as an "A.A. club," many clubs have been identified with A.A. because they are organized and directed by A.A. members and membership is limited to A.A.'s. Clubs where meetings are held and which are maintained for Twelfth Step as well as social purposes can avoid difficulties by abiding by A.A. Traditions. They should not use the A.A. name, however, and should be organized apart from A.A. They should not accept money from outside sources, being supported by membership dues and individual contributions from A.A. members. The question of a paid membership in A.A. does not arise, since A.A. meetings held in clubs are open to all. The Conference voiced recognition of the fact that clubs should operate within A.A. Traditions and abide by them to the fullest.

ANONYMITY BREAKS

The question of what can be done to keep anonymity breaks to a minimum is one that continually arises. The procedure at G.S.O. is to send letters explaining our Tradition of anonymity to the newspaper, the Delegate and the person involved. At the moment there is not much more we can do from this office, but Delegates can help if they stress the basic reasons for anonymity each time they visit an area or attend an Assembly meeting. These are:

1. Consideration for present members.
2. The attraction of anonymity to those who will approach us in the future.
3. The very meaningful spiritual foundation of our anonymity which reminds us to always place principles before personalities and thus keep our egos deflated.

Delegates should keep reminding Committee Members and G.S.R.'s why anonymity breaks hurt A.A. so they, in turn, will caution the groups.

The question has been raised as to whether anonymity breaks will increase in the years ahead. Although some think this Tradition will become harder and harder to maintain, facts point the other way. More and more A.A.'s appreciate the fact that anonymity is an A.A. responsibility, and that this responsibility rests squarely with you and me.

—Waneta N., G.S.O. Staff

ANSWER 5,317 INQUIRIES

Report

Public Health Agencies, among others.

General Service Delegates and/or local Public Information Committees manned our two professional exhibits at eight national conferences in the fields of education, welfare, medicine and social work.

At such conferences G.S.O. supplies quantities of the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community," along with request forms for other literature.

Two hundred additional requests for pamphlets were received from visitors to the Thirteenth International Conference of Social Work in Washington, D.C. One-third of these were from social workers in foreign countries.

In addition, the table-top "One-Way Display" was sent to five local and state professional gatherings in 1966.

During 1966, G.S.O. received 2,710 domestic clippings mentioning A.A. Among these were 34 anonymity breaks. A letter was sent to the media, individuals involved and the Delegate in the Area. This included appropriate material on A.A.'s Tradition of anonymity.

Other breaches of Traditions which came to light through clippings included: mention of an "A.A. Retreat"; violations of self-support involving a club for A.A.'s and an A.A. group; and a United Press story naming a "director of Alcoholics Anonymous." Information and pamphlets were sent to all persons involved through the Delegate in the Area.

During 1966 help and appropriate literature were provided to: Radio Pulse Beat News for a radio show on alcoholism; a film on industry; a writer preparing an article on women drinkers, and a writer doing a review on A.A. as a significant movement in human relations for the "Journal of Human Relations."

Two pamphlets were reviewed in 1966: "A.A. in Hospitals" in the March issue of the *Personnel Journal*, and "A Clergyman Asks About A.A." in *Register*, America's National Catholic Newspaper.

—Waneta N., G.S.O. Staff,
Information Services.

P.I. FOR GROWTH, SURVIVAL

Presentation

Conference members are ultimately responsible for the total, worldwide public information effort—an effort upon which A.A. must depend for its growth and—in the final analysis—for its very survival.

This does not seem farfetched in the light of A.A. history. Awareness of Bill and other oldtimers on the need to inform the public resulted in public information which produced a rate of growth that was truly phenomenal. Such a growth rate could never have been achieved through "personal contact" alone.

We want all alcoholics, everywhere, to have the same chance we had, so that they too may find A.A. But to find A.A. they must first know about it. And we can only let "them" know by letting everyone know—for we don't know who "they" are.

Our first responsibility is to be responsible. We must see that the Toronto pledge is carried out. And we can do this in a public information sense, by seeing to it that people everywhere learn about A.A. and what it can do. Here, in the United States and

Canada, our image shines brightly. Elsewhere, unfortunately, we are neither so well known nor so well accepted.

If we permit a false picture of A.A. to be projected, we shall all suffer for it. And while we cannot always control what others say about A.A., we *can* control what we ourselves reveal of it. Let us, then, see that the *correct* picture of A.A. is projected—by living it well and by telling it truly. —Robert H., Trustee

RADIO - TV ANNOUNCEMENT

The A.A. public service announcement was prepared last year for use on local radio and TV stations throughout the nation. Its purpose: to carry the message by telling people how and where to contact A.A.

Since these announcements have been made available, 112 have been ordered for TV and 121 for radio. While this is gratifying, it should be noted that it is only a beginning. There are 1,003 TV stations and more than 5,000 radio stations in North America.

A new TV spot was produced last fall. While following the same pattern, it has been improved in a number of ways. There is a slower pace so that the viewer can absorb the information more easily and it is more realistic. A box number is given for further information.

To my knowledge, no one has ever been turned down by a radio or television station manager regarding use of this public service announcement. All that is required is for the A.A. member (Delegate, G.S.R., public information committeeman, etc.) to contact the station manager and ask to tell him about the announcement.

A good way to insure positive results is to tell the station manager that you will let him know about results. Since all stations in the United States must report to the Federal Communications Commission on public service announcements they run, your help in this area will give the station more incentive to run the A.A. announcement. Tapes are available from G.S.O. at \$5 for radio, \$20 for the first TV print, \$15 for the second and \$10 for the third.

—Bayard P., Director A.A.W.S.

COOPERATION, YES!

Conference Action

The Public Information Committee of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. Delegates continue to establish lines of communication with tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas.
2. G.S.O. refer requests for *World Directory* from other agencies to Area Delegate for follow up.
3. Discussed ways that A.A.'s can best participate in the Annual Alcoholism Information Week, such as holding public meetings and appearing on programs, when invited, provided anonymity is preserved, and suggested the Trustees P.I.C. provide information concerning A.A. policy on this matter one month in advance of the event.
4. That the Trustees P.I.C. provide specific suggestions regarding all acceptable methods of preserving anonymity during TV appearances.
5. That Trustees P.I.C. seek opinion of International Doctors Group in A.A. on how groups can improve relations with doctors in their communities.
6. Elected Wayne W., Hawaii, as Chairman.

A.A. Around the World

International

Presentation

Your International Committee has been working over the past year not only to help carry the message of recovery to alcoholics overseas, but to help them arrive at a position where they can share their own strength and hope in the fullest possible measure, through translation of literature into their own languages, establishment of their own service centers and other activities which will lessen dependence on the World Service Office in New York.

In sharing our experience, strength and hope on behalf of the A.A. groups in North America, the International Committee has worked primarily in three areas:

1. To help A.A. groups overseas better understand the meaning and purpose of the Steps and Traditions.
2. To help them establish strong groups and efficient service offices.
3. To help them attain better translations and improved distribution of A.A. literature.

One of the most encouraging signs regarding A.A. development overseas is the prospect of an all-European Conference which may be held as early as 1968. Since there is no European Board to set up such a Conference, the International Committee has, on behalf of G.S.O., offered to give whatever guidance it can.

Currently we are sounding out General Service Offices and major Intergroups in Europe to gauge their thinking on the idea. If

there is enough agreement, we are in hopes that preliminary discussions can get underway at the Wiesbaden Roundup in Germany this fall.

Another International Committee project designed to stimulate overseas growth is a handbook which will incorporate much material already in existence to provide help and guidance for everyone from Loners to those about to establish major service offices.

In broad outline, it will show among other things, how a Loner can meet another alcoholic, a group can attract new members and how service offices can be established. It will tell them how to go about things, what mistakes to avoid, what written materials are available and how to get help from G.S.O.

The Translations Service continues to gather information on what literature is being translated, printed and used by A.A.'s overseas. The committee is completing an up-to-date file of translators available in this country, reviewing translations in several languages and compiling lists of available literature in several languages, while working with groups in various countries on translation problems.

The committee is seeking to stimulate A.A. growth in several countries by outlining to the groups ways in which they can attract new members, achieve unity, and establish service centers.

Membership of the International Committee is made up of A.A.'s who are specialists in various fields, such as language, medicine and communications, as well as those who visit different countries throughout the world in the course of business.

—Vincent Dole, M.D. and Niles P., Co-chairmen,
General Service Board International Committee.

AIMS OF G.S.O. OVERSEAS

Report

The purpose of G.S.O. service to overseas groups and members can be outlined as follows:

1. To provide a new member with support and encouragement in the form of correspondence and literature in his own language.
2. Offer continued support to developing groups.
3. Provide linkage between groups as they are formed.
4. Give assistance in the development of service centers and in development of literature printing and distribution.
5. Share early experience of A.A. here, with emphasis on Traditions.
6. To let go when it is evident that A.A. is growing in a healthy way.

In addition to frequent contact through correspondence, there are many service tools which provide practical help to overseas groups in achieving these aims. Among them: Box 4-5-9 to English-speaking groups; French and Spanish bulletins; 35 pieces of service materials that offer practical guides; a "Guide to Service Structure," and a "Manual of Guide Letters."

Today most overseas English-speaking groups order literature from the A.A. Publishing Company of Great Britain and Ireland. Among the highlights of overseas English-speaking A.A. is the formation of the first General Service Conference in the United

Kingdom. Response was enthusiastic and the second Conference will be held in October in Manchester.

In *Eire*, plans are underway for celebration of the 21st anniversary in November. New groups are being formed and there is a wakening public interest. An Irish National Council on Alcoholism has been formed and the State Minister for Health attended the Dublin Anniversary Dinner this year.

In *Australia*, strong local service centers have developed in each state but the development of an over-all service structure has been slow. However, a constitution has been accepted for all Australia and a national publishing company has been formed. A national office is planned for *New Zealand* to handle literature distribution.

There are now four groups in *Calcutta, India* with about 50 members. Newspaper ads and publicity are bringing good results. Help from non-A.A. friends is also contributing to growth. The Central Office in *Johannesburg, South Africa*, is well set up and now provides literature in English and Afrikaans to new groups.

Close contact is being maintained with Danshu Kai (the All Japan Sober Association) which has translated "This Is A.A." with portions of "Is A.A. for You?" into Japanese. The book, "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," is currently being checked by our Translations Service.

French-speaking groups receive literature from New York which has been translated and printed in French by the French Literature Council in Montreal. Several new groups have been formed in France where a Literature Committee has been formed to work in conjunction with their Service Board. In Belgium a Board serves both French and Flemish groups. As yet there is no over-all service center for the French-speaking groups in France, Belgium and Switzerland.

—Ann M., G.S.O. Staff,
International (English and French-speaking).

PLAN ALL EUROPEAN CONFERENCE

Presentation

The idea of an All-European Conference has long intrigued A.A.'s on both sides of the Atlantic. The benefits are apparent once the results and importance of our own North American Conferences are reviewed.

National conferences and round-ups have prepared the way and A.A.'s in several countries now feel that A.A. in Europe is ready to take this last step. We at G.S.O. have been asked to help and needless to say we are more than happy to do so.

We have written major service offices regarding a planning session to be held on Labor Day weekend at the Wiesbaden Round-up. We expect to have Ann M. at this session with the benefit of our Conference experience.

We believe they will want to build their Conference on the same basic principles upon which ours is built and we feel we can offer them useful guidelines, as well as save them from some of our early mistakes.

We feel that such a Conference will bring great benefits to European A.A., strengthening our Traditions and creating greater understanding of Third Legacy principles. It will hasten the financial independence of A.A. throughout Europe and to that degree, will relieve us of a financial burden that will enable us, in turn, to help alcoholics in other areas where A.A. is less advanced.

—Robert H., Trustee

OVERSEAS GROWTH STIMULATED

Report

During 1966 non-English-speaking A.A. groups overseas continued to grow as projects started in the past materialized and strengthened. Some of the exciting things that have been happening:

Germany. Directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., granted permission to the Literature Distribution Center in Bad Reichenhall to translate and print A.A. pamphlets. A loan of \$1,000 was approved to help start their printing program. This is to be repaid within 3 years.

Norway. A report of the National Conference held in Skien, Norway last May reveals continued growth and prosperity of Norwegian A.A. groups.

Sweden. Ulf T. from Stockholm, Sweden, visited G.S.O. in September. As a result of meetings with Ulf, four factors came to light which summarized problems with regard to growth of A.A. in Sweden:

1. They do not have a translation of the "Big Book."
2. Appropriation of A.A. material by Lankarna (the government-supported alcoholism program).
3. Lack of a central office to which inquirers may direct themselves.
4. Fear of exposure (anonymity).

The International Committee sent a letter to the eight A.A. groups in Sweden outlining suggestions to help the development of A.A. there.

Briefly, it was suggested that the groups finance a telephone answering service, run classified ads in local newspapers, begin translating the "Big Book" into Swedish and work toward developing an interest in A.A. among influential nonalcoholic professional people in Sweden.

At the same time Directors of A.A. World Services gave permission to the Central Committee in Sweden to reprint the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community," contacted Lankarna regarding the use of A.A. material without permission and took steps through Ivan Underwood, a former Trustee and member of the International Committee, to improve Swedish A.A.'s relationship with medicos in Sweden.

Honduras. A General Service Board and Literature Distribution Center is being formed at Tegucigalpa. A.A. World Services, Inc. granted them permission to reprint in Spanish: "This Is A.A." (with the questions from "Is A.A. for You?"), "44 Questions," and "The 12 Steps and 12 Traditions."

Brazil. Permission has been granted to translate the "Big Book" into Portuguese. A Translation Committee was formed and is translating the first 11 chapters.

Colombia. The Literature Distribution Center at Medellin is serving groups in South America and also sharing experience with the new Board being developed in Honduras.

Uruguay. A group started in Montevideo now reports 400 active members. Information has been requested on how to start smaller groups. We are encouraging correspondence from this area in order to help.

The Spanish Bulletin goes out bimonthly to 960 groups, enabling them to share experience with each other.

Closer contact was made with A.A. groups in non-English-speaking areas by visits of members of the International Committee to Scandinavian countries, Spain, Central and Latin America.

At the same time G.S.O. had a number of visitors from countries, such as Sweden, Switzerland, Belgium, Colombia and Honduras. Visitors had many questions regarding operation of G.S.O. and Staff experience.

—Beth K., G.S.O. Staff,
International (Europe and Spanish-speaking).

TRANSLATIONS SERVICE

The Translations Service helps A.A. groups here and overseas obtain translations faithful to original Conference-approved literature. We are making a complete inventory of all translations at G.S.O. and have appealed for volunteers to check material. We now have members who can work in twelve languages. We plan eventually to prepare a manual on how to produce translations with suggestions on the best method of setting up local committees. We will work closely with these committees and also pass along experience of other groups. We need more translators. Although we are well supplied with help in Spanish, French and German, we can use volunteers in other languages. Names of bilingual A.A. members who might be interested should be submitted to G.S.O.

—Jean R., International Committee

REPORT AND CHARTER

Conference Action

The Conference Report and Charter Committee of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That the Highlights edition of the *Conference Digest* announce the availability of the *Final Conference Report*.
2. That Delegates urge G.S.R.'s to order a copy of the *Report* for group use.
3. That the rough draft of the *Final Report* be reviewed and returned one week after receipt.
4. Elected Bill W., Louisiana, Chairman.

A.A. Thinking Clarified

Policy

Report

The Policy Committee met in April, October and January on the Sunday before Board meetings. All Trustees, Directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staff, Public Information and International Committee members are invited to these meetings. With 30 to 35 present, deliberations of this "Town-Hall-type meeting" form the basis not only for recommendations of the Board, but also to clarify our A.A. thinking and experience.

Reports are presented from A.A.W.S., Grapevine, Public Information and International Committees, Trustees and Staff. The committee discusses A.A. policy and makes recommendations to the Board. Actions taken by Policy are reported in other Committee reports.

Some of the subjects discussed at Policy meetings were:

1. Agenda subjects for the Annual Conference.
2. Discussion on sponsorship in A.A., what it involves, its importance to A.A.'s future.
3. Communications within A.A.
4. Anonymity on a mixed TV panel.
5. Passage of a resolution commending Janet G. and Bill W. for their work in compiling the new book, "A.A. Way of Life."
6. Methods of improving our communications and reaching out more effectively to those who are reaching out to us.
7. Position paper on A.A.'s relationship with club houses and rehabilitations centers, and Guidelines for group separation of A.A. and Al-Anon.

Although basically a committee to pursue general policy, the Policy Committee does make strong recommendations to the Board when indicated. Voting members number 12: five Regional Trustees; two nonalcoholic Trustees; the Chairman of General Services; the Treasurer of A.A.W.S., Treasurer of the Grapevine and two Staff Members. A Regional Trustee is Chairman.

—Jim M., Chairman,
G.S.B. Policy Committee

CONFERENCE POLICY COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Policy Committee of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That ex officio Committee Members be continued but only after being queried following January Policy Committee Meeting, as to whether they would like to continue as ex officio. Only if they answer in the affirmative will they be kept on the Committee list as ex officio for one year.
2. That a letter again be sent from G.S.O. to the F.B.I. advising them of the confidential nature of the *Directory*.
3. That even though Assemblies may be held every year with half of the Committee elected each year, it be clarified in the Third Legacy Manual that the term of office is for two years.
4. That there be no change in the Delegate expense allowance.
5. Elected Steve P., Central New York, Chairman.

EFFECTIVE GROUP CONSCIENCE

Interview Time

How effective is the group conscience of the groups in your area regarding: a) rotation? b) participation? c) Twelve Step work? d) speaking? e) steering committee? Delegates were polled on these questions and also offered a number of comments. The results:

1. Rotation. With comments ranging from "same people all the time" to excellent, 33 Delegates said that rotation was good in their areas, while 20 said that it left something to be desired.
2. Participation. With comments ranging from "fair" to "good."

WORKSHOPS

BETTER USE OF PAST DELEGATES

Asked during Workshop meetings how to make better use of past Delegates, current Delegates offered a number of answers, among which were:

1. Move on to another two-year office, such as treasurer of state committee so participation is insured.
2. Ask to continue as advisors, to fill in on committees and help select officers.
3. Ask them to organize active committees in order to take advantage of their experience—public information, institutions, literature, etc.
4. Send them out on speaking engagements to educate groups and general public; have them run workshops.
5. Create a structure that will stress the importance of past Delegates.

STATE ASSEMBLY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Asked during Workshop meetings what the accomplishments of the State Assembly had been during the past year, Delegates cited the following:

1. Set up group directory.
2. Help bring groups and G.S.R.'s together.
3. Set up active committees.
4. Reactivated Third Legacy procedures.
5. Elected woman Delegate.
6. Get financially solvent
7. Set up annual meetings for Area.
8. Raised money for G.S.O.
9. Played part in state alcoholism program.
10. Increased subscriptions for Grapevine.
11. Gained total Area participation.

MOST AREAS FOLLOW THIRD LEGACY

Toward the end of the Workshop session a poll was taken among Delegates in order to find out how many Areas were following Third Legacy procedure. Out of 89 Delegates, most reported that their Areas were following Third Legacy procedure completely. Ten were not following it at all. The majority of participants said they thought Third Legacy procedure should be left as it is, except that qualifications for officer candidates should be added.

New Trustees Nominated, Qualification Format Made

Nominating

Report

Among the Committee's actions during the past year:

1. Nominated Robert H. as an A.A. General Service Trustee; nominated Robert W.P. Morse (non-A.A. Trustee) as Treasurer of the General Service Board, and approved selection of Ruth W. for election as a Trustee at the annual meeting of the Board in April.
2. Reviewed the resumes of 34 Regional Trustee candidates from five Regions (Southeast, Canada East, East Central, Southwest and Pacific) and accepted the eligibility of all 34 candidates.
3. Prepared a format on qualifications of the "A.A. Trustee" for guidance of the Trustees' Nominating Committee. As it might be useful to others, it was distributed to the Conference Committee on Trustees and Delegates involved in the 1967 Regional Trustee Elections.
4. Recommended there be no change in the present procedure for filling unexpired Regional trusteeships.
5. Accepted revised procedure for pre-selection of General Service Trustees (non-New York), as follows:

"The Board would set up 'specifications' to cover the kind of business and professional qualifications needed to fill a vacancy. All states and provinces would be asked to submit qualified names by January 15. The Conference Committee on Trustees would be invited to meet with the Trustees' Nominating Committee in joint session on the Sunday preceding the first Conference Session to discuss all candidates and to reduce the number to four for each vacancy. At the Conference annual meeting, the entire Conference would use Third Legacy procedures to select one name for each vacancy for election by the Board."
6. Recommended that the following be elected Trustees of the General Service Board:

NON-A.A. TRUSTEES

Dr. Travis Dancey
Dr. Vincent Dole
Austin MacCormick
Robert W. P. Morse
Hon. John Murtagh
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith
Prof. Harrison Trice

A.A. TRUSTEES

Charles (Edw.) L., Jr.
Murray W.
Ruth W.
Robert H.
Tom B.
Frank R.

Five Regional Trustee candidates will be added to this following their nomination at the General Service Conference. One each to come from the following Regions: Southeast, Canada East, East Central, Southwest, Pacific.

7. Recommended the following officers of the General Service Board be elected at the annual meeting of the Board in April:

Chairman — Dr. John L. Norris
1st Vice-Chairman — Bernard B. Smith
2nd Vice-Chairman — Murray W.
Secretary — Charles (Edw.) L., Jr.
Treasurer — Robert W. P. Morse
Asst. Secretary — Eve M.

Following three-minute presentations and voting under Third-Legacy procedures, five regional Trustee candidates were named and presented to the General Service Board for election. They are: Maurice R., Southeast; Rollie D., Canada East; Andy A., East Central; Katharine P., Southwest, and Eric B., Pacific. This brings to eight the number of Regional Trustees, as established at the 1966 Conference.

—Eugene K., Chairman,
General Service Board Nominating Committee

FURTHER STUDY OF ELECTIONS

Conference Action

The Committee on Trustees of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That only one presentation be made of a Trustee candidate.
2. That the revised procedure for pre-selection of Trustees be accepted and that the chart for adjustment of starting dates for Regional Trustees be accepted so that with the 1975 election two Regional Trustees will come on the Board each year and then each Region will have full four-year terms.
3. Recommended that the Board study procedures for electing Regional Trustees with special consideration given to withdrawals and drawing by lot.
4. Elected Sam M., West Virginia, as Chairman.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. What has been the experience in electing those who work in the field of alcoholism as Assembly officers or Conference Delegates?
 - A. The consensus of Delegates was that it is difficult to wear two hats — that one activity will suffer at the expense of the other and the purposes of each will become confused.
- Q. Could all Central Offices be provided with a copy of the "Group Handbook?"
 - A. Several Offices have ordered copies of the "Group Handbook" and they are available for sale to groups. Steps are being taken to make sure everyone knows of their availability.

Bill Thanks Delegates For A.A. Throughout World

In bringing to a close the 17th General Service Conference, Bill thanked Delegates on behalf of A.A. throughout the world. "Your work is here for us to see and it will be felt out on the far reaches of A.A.," he said.

Bill spoke of the years before the General Service Board was created and of how it came into being with only one vote to spare. He told of the years when it operated in comparative isolation and of how the responsibility for General Service was turned over to the groups in 1955 at St. Louis.

"At that time," he said, "I felt that my part of this thing was fully delegated. And today my eyes, my ears and my heart conspire to tell me that A.A. is safe at last. Thank God."

John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman of the General Service Board, told Delegates that they had again helped to provide two-way communication between G.S.O. and the groups. "Unless communication is both ways, it is not communication at all," he said, noting that the office sends a great deal of material out, but that it needs the feedback of the Conference to know if it is doing the job.

Archibald Roosevelt, who is retiring as Treasurer but staying on as Trustee, thanked Delegates for the "help and inspiration you have given me" and said that one thing he had found out in A.A. was that "if I want to be happy, I can't be happy until I make you happy, too."

Jim M. told Conference members that he was grateful to have been allowed to make some contribution. "If I have any regrets on changes that were not made or projects not completed, I can still leave in comfort because I know the dedication of the new Trustees and Delegates.

"It is a long way from Skid Row in Vallejo to this podium, a long way from a time when no one cared whether I lived or died. It was then that the hand of A.A. was offered. Since that time, I have learned that the only thing I can do to keep on living is to pass on to others what has so freely been given to me," Jim said.

VOICE OF WORLD A.A.

I was elected Trustee at a time when I had no precise knowledge as to how the General Service Board functioned. Furthermore, I had little desire to learn. I was quite satisfied with A.A. as it was in 1945 when I came into it. I took literally Dr. Bob's admonition of 1950, "Let's keep it simple." I was not even sure I was sympathetic with the whole setup.

Herb said, too, that three years is a very short time... and it has been. The trusteeship has been a wonderful personal experience. Getting really to know Bill, my fellow Trustees and the Staff Members has been great. Gaining an appreciation of the multitudinous tasks that the Staff performs and the magnitude of some of them has been an eye opener. Believe me when I say that I have never seen a harder working or more faithful group.

In the three years I have been Trustee at no time has a decision of the Conference been overruled — making the Conference as stated in the "Third Legacy Manual," "the practical way by which A.A.'s group conscience can speak and put its desires for world service into operation. It is the voice of world A.A. and the permanent guarantee that our world services shall continue to function under all conditions."

—Bruce M., Trustee, G.S.B.

CONFERENCE FOR GOOD OF A.A.

"It has been my privilege to participate in five Conferences and they have been a revelation to me," Gene K., retiring A.A. Trustee said at the concluding Conference session.

Gene noted that he had seen the group conscience take over during a stormy session when general agreement on some question seemed impossible and said that the close relationship between Delegates and the Board was among the most pleasant memories he would take from the Conference.

Speaking of his term as a Trustee, Gene said: "I've made my mistakes, I've changed my mind, and on a few occasions I've compromised when I finally became convinced that to do so was in the best interest of A.A. as a whole. All in all, not much of a record, I guess. Always I got more from you than I gave."

He spoke, too, of 25 years ago — of entering a hospital with the shakes, a three-day growth of beard, and a feeling of utter hopelessness.

"Out of all that this past 25 years," he said, "I know that it will not be given to a man like me to witness a miracle. This has been miracle enough... anything more would be too frightening."

WHAT? ME?

In stepping down next year as General Manager of G.S.O., Herb M. noted that one of the built-in weaknesses of rotation turns up "when you feel it applied to yourself. Then you can't help but feel: What? Me?"

"Seven years ago I felt this when I stood up here and said goodbye as a Trustee, but the Fellowship rolled purposefully along.

"And it would be inconsistent with my personality if I did not feel now that this indispensability bit might have a different meaning as far as I'm concerned. Then I check back and remember — remember that in every case it was the work that A.A.'s did that was important, not they themselves.

"Our custom of rotation, as we see it, is more than a device to keep oldtimers from freezing on to jobs, or to keep small cliques from running the show year after year.

"It's more than that. It recognizes the fact that it took hundreds of A.A.'s during the early years — and thousands in later years — to build the program and the Traditions and the structure into a strong and enduring Fellowship. And there simply would not have been room enough for all these contributions if the early settlers had sat and sat — and refused to move over. In a Fellowship like ours — without a government in any true sense — and with a program that is self-help and mutual-help — we need room for many, many people to participate.

"As much as we might personally miss those who pass on to other service, their going makes the opportunity for others to come along with their contributions to the Fellowship's growth and health. The real mark of their value to A.A. lay in their ability to develop people and methods that would serve A.A. well long after they had left. This perhaps is just another way of saying what we all believe: Principles Before Personalities. You see, this wonderful Tradition applies to people as well as events," he concluded.

Financial Operations Okay

Contributions Increase 13%

Finance

Report

Financial operations through 1966 were very satisfactory. Contributions exceeded anticipated receipts by 5% and were 13% more than in 1965. Net income from publishing was 16.5% in excess of budget, while actual expenses came within 1% of the budgeted figure.

The Committee reviewed the G.S.O. 1967 budget and noted that a 7% increase in sales is budgeted for 1967. Total publishing expenses are budgeted 8.8% over 1966. Contributions are figured at \$19,800 (or 6.2%) over 1966. Total office expenses are budgeted 8.8% higher than 1966 and General Fund expenses 3.5% higher. Total excess of expense is estimated to be \$5,700 (exclusive of any dividend which may be forthcoming from the Grapevine for 1967).

The title of Controller was established by A.A. World Services, Inc. and the Finance Committee reviewed the responsibilities and duties of this job. Under direction of the Finance Committee and the Treasurer, the Controller is responsible for the financial picture as it affects the General Service Board and A.A.W.S.

As a newcomer, taking a fresh look at the A.A. operation, I have noticed some areas where there might be improvement. However, my over-all impression is of an organization that runs extremely well, providing excellent service and fulfilling its mission to an admirable degree. This high level of service is maintained with the support of A.A. members. This doctrine of self-support is indeed unique, providing A.A. with dignity, character and strength.

—Robert W. P. Morse,

Chairman, G.S. Board Finance Committee.

REGULAR CONTRIBUTION PLAN

The Regular Contribution Plan is now well launched. Since Conference approval in April, 1965, each group has been invited to make its contribution to G.S.O. on a regular monthly, bimonthly, or quarterly basis.

The yardstick of \$3 per year per member then becomes 25 cents per month per member, putting group support of worldwide services on the same basis as rent, telephone or any other regular operating expense.

The objectives of the Regular Contribution Plan are twofold:

1. To spread contributions over the year and prevent operating in the red in the first half.
2. To put self-support on a business basis. As the plan develops, it is hoped that it will raise group contributions to match group service expenses.

To keep itself better informed each group receives a quarterly statement showing its contributions for the year. Twice a year duplicate copies are sent to each Delegate for groups in his Area.

Of course, if a group has not sent in a contribution, its statement looks mighty blank. Each group is now informed as to what contributions it has made, and every Delegate knows what each group in his Area is doing.

Many groups have expressed their thanks for the quarterly reminder of their obligation to G.S.O. In the past, some groups had

not contributed because they had "just forgotten to." Others have had a change-over in officers who "didn't know." In any event, a new link in our communication chain has been forged.

More and more groups are using the Regular Contribution Plan. In 1965 — 14% of the 5,205 contributing groups were giving regularly. In 1966 — 20% of 5,620 contributing groups were giving regularly, a substantial gain. Also in 1966 — 59.5% of all groups in the United States and Canada contributed, as compared with 57% in 1965.

Ideally, we would hope that eventually 70% of the North American groups would be sharing in the service expenses of G.S.O. — a goal it might take Delegates and their Area Service Committees years to attain; therefore, well worth the effort.

There are also side benefits to the quarterly acknowledgment system not anticipated. By inserting letters, each mailing gives us an opportunity to be in touch with the groups. A letter was included recently asking about referrals of new members to A.A. Response was good. A note on the 1967 *World Directory* is being included in the April mailing, noting that this is one of the many services group contributions supports.

Groups are encouraged to correspond more frequently and take advantage of all services. Records and Accounting Departments are receiving more current and up-to-date information — changes of address, inactive groups and posting errors, for instance.

The increased support of groups, along with increasing flow of information, will assure a stronger bond between G.S.O. and the groups. The Regular Contribution Plan is a simple, business-like solution to the problem of support. The direction is clear, yet it will take a lot of work by all of us to make it a realization.

Dennis Manders, Controller

DELEGATES ALLOWANCE

Conference Action

The Finance Committee of the General Service Conference took the following actions:

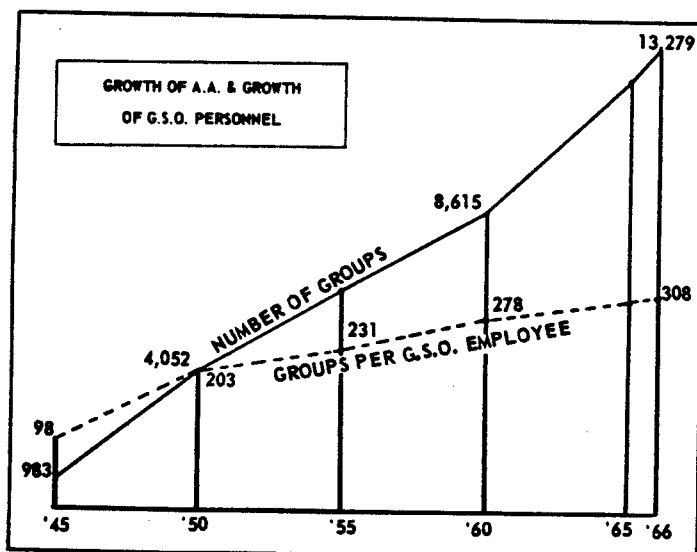
1. Recommended that Delegate expense allowance remained unchanged.
2. Discussed plan to consider an additional allowance for an extra hotel night in cases where Delegates come from a distance.
3. Recommended that the General Service Board make use of investment income from the Reserve Fund for whatever purpose the Board may authorize.
4. Reported that the Regular Contribution Plan seemed to be growing slowly but surely in most areas.
5. Suggested that some consideration be given to reversing the clauses in the preamble to read as follows: "We are self-supporting through our own contributions; there are no dues or fees for A.A. membership."
6. Elected Ed S., Connecticut, Chairman.

Growth & Money at G.S.O.

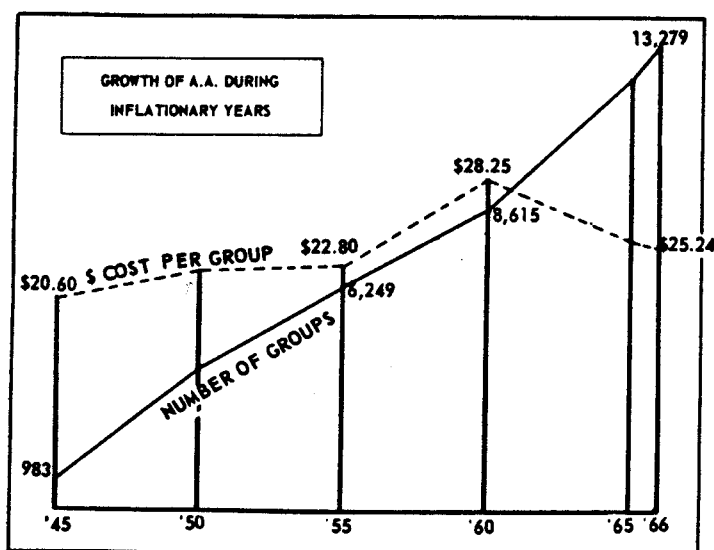
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel — In 1945 there was one employee for each 98 Groups. Today, one employee serves each 308 Groups.

During the past twenty-one years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$20,000 to \$364,000 for services charged to the Group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 80%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per Group actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$14.01.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1945	983	10	98	\$ 20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1966	13,279	43	308	25.24	180



1. (Above) There are more than 13 times as many Groups today as in 1945. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 308 Groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 98 in 1945.



2. (Above) During the years 1945 through 1966, the cost of living increased 80 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per Group to \$25.24 in 1966 compared with \$20.60 in 1945, an increase of only 23 percent.

1967 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1967 Operations of G.S.O. activities — exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine — is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$337,500*
Less: Cost of Products	131,600
Gross Profit from Sales	205,900

TOTAL EXPENSES

155,000

Excess of Income (Expense)

\$ 50,900

*Based upon the sale of:

- 37,900 Books—"Alcoholics Anonymous"
- 12,400 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Reg.)
- 4,100 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Pocket)
- 4,000 Books—"A.A. Comes of Age"
- Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

OFFICE EXPENSES — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$335,200
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TOTAL EXPENSES

364,100**

Excess of Income (Expense)

\$(28,900)

**Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$32,700.

GENERAL FUND—TRUSTEES' EXPENSES

INCOME

\$ —0—

TOTAL EXPENSES

27,700***

Excess of Income (Expense)

\$(27,700)

***Board Meetings, PIC Expense, Special Projects, etc.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$50,900 to the total budgeted deficit of \$56,600. The Balance totaling \$5,700 will be covered by income earned by the Reserve Fund, and a dividend from the Grapevine.

1967 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and bulk sales.....	\$188,000
Estimated expenses.....	186,300
Net income from operations.....	1,700
Interest on savings accounts	4,000
Net income.....	\$ 5,700

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie,

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership. Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,
Bill
(Signed in full)

WGW/nw

P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

UP CONTRIBUTION LIMIT TO \$200

Conference Action

Following a presentation by Steve O., a Director of A.A. World Services, the 1967 General Service Conference voted to increase the ceiling on the amount an individual can contribute to the General Service Office from \$100 a

year to \$200.

Steve noted that the \$100 limit was established in 1954 and was determined at that time as 1/10 of 1% of the G.S.O. annual budget. Since that time, for instance, the cost of living index has increased by about 135%.

While this figure would justify a greater increase than \$100, it was felt best to set a limit that would be readily attainable by a number of people — not one so high as to make it appear that G.S.O. was promoting large contributions.

MIAMI NEGOTIATIONS COMPLETE

Herb M., Chairman of A.A. World Services, reported to the Conference that he and Hazel R., Staff Member, visited the Miami Beach Convention Bureau in August, 1966 and found facilities for A.A.'s 1970 Convention to be fully adequate. Negotiations have now been completed with the Convention Bureau and participating hotels. The Convention Hall fits requirements for all big night meetings and the Sunday evening show. There will be no Convention Hall charges for A.A. meetings. Ample rooms within five miles of Convention Hall have been set aside to meet A.A. needs. Bus Service will be made available. The Fontainebleau Hotel will be A.A.'s headquarters hotel. The underwriting of the Florida Host Committee Guarantee fund of \$6,500 has been matched by a deposit of \$6,500 by the General Service Board of A.A. The fund will be used to underwrite any Convention deficit on a pro-rata basis. If there is no deficit, the money will be returned.

SEPARATION OF A.A., AL-ANON

Conference Action

The 17th General Service Conference voiced approval of Guidelines for group separation of A.A. and Al-Anon. The Guidelines noted: The use of the word "family" should be deleted from an A.A. group's name; that so-called

"joint groups" dilute the help available in each Fellowship; either A.A. or Al-Anon can hold open discussion meetings but a group cannot be both; that officers should be either A.A.'s or Al-Anon depending upon affiliation, and that newer members be encouraged to stick to either an A.A. or Al-Anon group since they will get the most help by staying close to the group relating to their problem.

Ask-It-Basket

Q. What is our experience with the F.B.I.?

A. After many Delegates revealed they had been asked to provide information on A.A. members to the F.B.I. the consensus was that an A.A. group, in keeping with our Tradition of anonymity should not make its mailing list or World Directory available for the purpose of apprehending a wanted individual.

However, individual A.A. members can cooperate to the extent they think necessary. Austin MacCormick, non-alcoholic Trustee and penal authority, noted that if the F.B.I. was seeking information regarding a wanted individual, there is no legal right to consider this a confidential relationship.

A Staff Member noted that A.A. has its Tradition of anonymity, although it does not set itself above the law or participate in hiding wanted individuals. She suggested that it might be a good idea to reacquaint the F.B.I. with our general policy along these lines. After further discussion a show of hands backed this idea and such a letter will be prepared and sent.

1966 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alabama	65	13	20.0%	36	55%	\$ 2,717.18	1,300	\$ 2.09
Alaska	30	5	16.6	15	50	1,383.88	350	3.96
Arizona	99	10	9.9	59	60	2,085.24	1,422	1.47
Arkansas	61	10	16.5	42	69	1,915.71	950	2.02
California	1,217	194	15.9	696	57	45,688.55	24,484	1.87
Colorado	87	10	11.5	59	69	3,294.33	1,532	2.15
Connecticut	146	18	12.3	101	69	6,652.83	2,563	2.60
Delaware	26	7	27.0	18	70	1,125.25	336	3.35
Dist. of Columbia	41	18	43.9	34	83	3,307.00	1,047	3.16
Florida	267	43	16.1	148	55	11,056.06	3,924	2.82
Georgia	128	17	13.3	86	67	3,489.57	1,905	1.83
Hawaii	28	3	10.7	18	64	755.50	360	2.10
Idaho	34	4	11.8	21	62	702.75	377	1.86
Illinois	565	39	6.0	407	72	9,319.43	10,655	.98
Indiana	195	24	12.3	113	59	5,797.30	2,394	1.17
Iowa	99	10	10.1	61	62	4,570.15	1,946	2.35
Kansas	100	10	10.0	57	57	2,748.33	1,785	1.54
Kentucky	92	7	7.6	66	62	6,479.90	1,128	5.74
Louisiana	101	5	5.0	53	52	3,543.61	1,656	2.14
Maine	46	3	6.5	34	75	1,260.61	568	2.22
Maryland	90	15	16.6	80	89	4,194.50	1,535	2.73
Massachusetts	210	24	11.4	112	53	7,118.00	3,930	1.81
Michigan	369	56	15.2	186	50	13,242.38	6,069	2.18
Minnesota	292	11	37.7	128	44	8,207.72	4,956	1.66
Mississippi	42	6	14.3	22	52	1,615.50	727	2.22
Missouri	157	17	10.8	89	57	4,567.14	2,114	2.16
Montana	44	5	11.3	29	66	849.00	561	1.51
Nebraska	57	9	15.8	48	84	2,264.86	717	3.16
Nevada	40	5	12.5	26	65	1,094.00	980	1.12
New Hampshire	33	5	15.2	17	51	917.00	464	1.98
New Jersey	247	33	13.4	158	64	8,402.75	3,614	2.33
New Mexico	53	4	7.5	35	66	1,840.42	918	2.00
New York	511	90	17.6	344	67	24,796.49	9,751	2.54
North Carolina	197	16	8.1	109	55	4,791.46	3,350	1.43
North Dakota	46	2	4.3	24	52	867.66	522	1.66
Ohio	434	31	7.1	255	59	13,025.97	8,448	1.54
Oklahoma	115	41	35.6	73	63	5,080.84	1,682	3.02
Oregon	120	20	16.6	69	58	2,783.32	1,214	2.29
Pennsylvania	298	43	14.4	181	61	11,139.26	5,291	2.11
Rhode Island	31	5	16.1	22	71	1,156.90	524	2.21
South Carolina	80	9	11.0	46	58	2,879.11	1,237	2.33
South Dakota	52	5	9.6	26	50	1,087.00	911	1.19
Tennessee	72	8	11.1	46	46	2,109.03	1,193	1.77
Texas	404	34	8.4	210	52	11,881.92	7,406	1.60
Utah	59	3	5.0	28	45	867.84	786	1.10
Vermont	34	1	2.9	22	65	1,373.00	375	3.66
Virginia	134	20	15.0	75	56	6,110.00	2,437	2.52
Washington	227	24	10.6	109	48	6,074.53	2,480	2.45
West Virginia	38	5	13.2	23	61	1,457.25	533	2.74
Wisconsin	188	6	3.2	106	56	4,305.22	2,403	1.79
Wyoming	31	1	3.2	15	48	748.12	375	2.00
Commonwealth of P.R.	37	4	10.8	19	51	733.75	527	1.39
Canal Zone	2	1	50.0	2	100	328.12	44	7.46
TOTAL for U.S.	8,171	1,009	12.4%	4,858	59.5%	\$275,803.24	138,756	\$ 1.99

CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alberta	129	10	7.7%	71	55%	\$ 3,696.08	1,314	\$ 2.81
Atlantic Prov.								
New Brunswick	35	3	8.6	28	80	912.55	469	1.95
Newfoundland	12	2	16.6	4	33	337.95	157	2.15
Nova Scotia	58	3	5.2	31	53	1,034.77	684	1.51
Prince Ed. Is.	19	—	0.0	9	47	426.90	250	1.71
Brit. Columbia	182	4	2.2	102	56	4,891.23	2,264	2.16
Manitoba	72	3	4.2	43	60	2,381.84	1,383	1.72
N.W. Territories	2	—	0.0	1	50	70.00	18	3.89
Ontario	390	27	6.9	251	64	12,841.58	5,522	2.33
Quebec	259	31	12.0	157	61	5,119.29	5,172	.99
Saskatchewan	121	5	4.1	64	53	2,722.76	1,357	2.01
Yukon Terr.	3	—	0.0	1	33	39.20	40	.99
TOTAL for CANADA	1,282	88	6.9%	762	59.5%	\$ 34,474.15	18,630	\$ 1.85
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	9,452	1,096	11.6%	5,620	59.5%	\$310,277.39	157,386	\$ 1.97

FOREIGN	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Foreign	2,522			\$ 3,285.40	48,082	
Lone Members					366	
World Hello				32.50		
International Doctors				558.25		
Hospital Gps.	561			952.32	14,384	
Prison Groups	737			256.75	29,805	
Internationalist				125.00	335	
GRAND TOTAL	13,279			\$315,487.61	251,355	

GROUP CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1965-66						
	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
U.S.A. 1966	8,171	4,858	59.5%	\$275,803.24	138,756	\$ 1.99
U.S.A. 1965	7,821	4,509	58	242,855.84	133,786	1.82
Increase (Decrease)	350	349	1.5%	\$ 32,947.40	4,970	\$.17
Canada 1966	1,282	762	59.5%	\$ 34,474.15	18,630	\$ 1.85
Canada 1965	1,241	696	56	31,253.21	17,180	1.82
Increase (Decrease)	41	66	3.5%	\$ 3,220.94	1,450	\$.03
U.S.A. & Canada '66	9,452	5,620	59.5%	\$310,277.39	157,386	\$ 1.97
U.S.A. & Canada '65	9,062	5,205	57	274,109.05	150,966	1.82
Increase (Decrease)	391	415	2.5%	\$ 36,168.34	6,420	\$.15

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1966

	<u>1966</u>	<u>1965</u>
INCOME		
Net Sales, after Book Discounts waived of \$22,849 in 1966 and \$19,884 in 1965	\$315,047	\$274,954
Less: Cost of Printing	90,658	78,070
Royalties	<u>32,427</u>	<u>28,372</u>
Gross Profit from Literature	191,962	168,512
Contributions — A.A. Groups and Members	315,388	278,996
— The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	5,000	750
— Other	619	
Net Income of 30th Anniversary Convention		<u>12,948</u>
Total Income	<u>\$512,969</u>	<u>\$461,206</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	\$257,623	\$240,435
Rent	34,386	33,877
Exchange Bulletin	11,401	11,975
World Directory	15,950	18,487
Other Service Office Printing	4,826	7,214
Shipping and Mailing	34,303	29,966
Other Office Expenses	45,408	37,513
Insurance and Taxes	22,750	19,516
Professional Services, Gifts	11,700	12,518
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	8,385	8,362
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	14,594	12,345
P.I.C., Travel	6,920	7,265
General Service Conference	31,905	31,530
Foreign Literature Aid	3,147	1,850
Film, Film Strip, Display Boards	<u>1,991</u>	<u>2,502</u>
Total Expense	<u>\$505,289</u>	<u>\$475,355</u>
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) (Exhibit C)	<u>7,680</u>	<u>(14,149)</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
World Service Office — Group Fund	(\$ 19,793)	(\$ 40,074)
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.	49,242	38,214
General Fund — General Service Board	(21,769)	(12,289)
CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS — 1966		
	<u>Pension</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Balance, January 1	\$ 23,384	\$313,403
Book Discounts	22,849	
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	3,500	
Investment Income (net)	363	13,472
Less: Fundings Costs Paid Retirement Trust	(38,500)	
Actuary Fee	<u>(865)</u>	
Balance, December 31	<u>\$ 10,731</u>	<u>\$326,875</u>
() Denotes Red Figures		

In the financial statements amounts under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the Retirement Plan for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

INCOME STATEMENT

EXHIBIT B

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1966

	<u>1966</u>	<u>1965</u>
INCOME — SUBSCRIPTIONS AND SALES	\$176,063	\$173,862
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS		
Salaries	35,035	32,676
Printing	42,307	38,984
Mailing	18,203	17,773
Rent	5,232	5,230
Telephone	1,099	1,106
Office Supplies and Expense	2,946	2,765
Office Cleaning	500	500
Total	<u>\$105,322</u>	<u>\$ 99,034</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	\$ 29,852	\$ 29,116
Stationery and Supplies	1,572	1,475
Rent	5,232	5,230
Telephone	839	832
Office Expense	2,153	2,110
Bad Debts	392	259
Conference and Convention	243	955
Selling	5,747	3,354
Postage	3,298	3,143
Office Cleaning	500	500
Total	<u>\$ 49,828</u>	<u>\$ 46,974</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	\$ 2,980	\$ 2,879
Legal and Accounting	2,400	2,500
Taxes	4,277	4,342
Meetings	429	354
New Equipment	73	908
Contribution to Retirement Plan	3,500	3,500
Total	<u>\$ 13,659</u>	<u>\$ 14,483</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>\$168,809</u>	<u>\$160,491</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	\$ 7,254	\$ 13,371
Add: Interest Received	3,613	2,730
Less: Contribution to G.S.B.		(750)
NET INCOME FOR PERIOD (Exhibit C)	<u>\$ 10,867</u>	<u>\$ 15,351</u>

(continued from page 39)

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

In the statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, and of the other Funds by their names.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

EXHIBIT C

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1966

OPERATING FUNDS	December 31, 1966		December 31, 1965	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$108,283	\$110,278	\$125,210	\$ 97,561
Accounts Receivable	8,631	2,750	9,965	2,415
Due from Grapevine or Reserve Fund	5,000		5,800	
Inventories	83,900	1,960	68,900	2,162
Prepaid Expenses	9,104	8,098	15,042	7,754
Total Assets	\$214,918	\$123,086	\$224,917	\$109,892
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	11,458	2,433	10,315	3,353
Due Pension Fund	1,681		19,884	3,500
Due General Fund		5,000		
Prepaid Subscriptions, Unearned Income		74,937	619	68,190
Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments		7,000		
Total Liabilities	\$ 13,139	\$ 89,370	\$ 30,818	\$ 75,043
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	194,099	34,849	195,948	19,498
Net Income (Expenses) for Year (Exhibits A and B)	7,680	10,867	(14,149)	15,351
Donation to General Fund		(5,000)		
Transfers:				
Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments		(7,000)		
Reserve Fund			5,800	
Convention Guaranty Fund			6,500	
Total Net Worth	\$210,779	\$ 33,716	\$194,099	\$ 34,849
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
World Service Office - Group Fund (Note B)	\$ 11,179		\$ 10,972	
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	127,481		127,239	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Notes A and B)	63,119		55,888	
Total Operating Funds - as above	201,779		194,099	
Reserve Fund	326,874		313,403	
Deferred Pension Fund	10,731		23,384	
Total Net Worth	\$539,384		\$530,886	
RESERVE AND DEFERRED PENSION FUNDS	Reserve	Pension	Reserve	Pension
Cash	\$ 34,054	\$ 14,100	\$ 27,301	
Due from A.A.W.S. and Grapevine		1,681		\$ 23,384
U.S. Treasury Obligations	284,840		279,176	
Corporate Bonds	4,800		9,356	
Accrued Interest	3,180		3,370	
Less: Due General Fund			(5,800)	
A.A. Retirement Trust		(5,050)		
PRINCIPAL OF FUND	\$326,874	\$ 10,731	\$313,403	\$ 23,384

() Denotes Red Figures

NOTE A - After transfers of \$49,000 in 1966, and \$41,000 in 1965 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B - Advances of \$20,000 in 1966 and \$40,000 in 1965 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in Group contributions in those years.

The financial statements and above notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

1967 CONFERENCE MEMBERS*

Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

Bill Wilson — Co-founder

G.S.B. TRUSTEES

NONALCOHOLIC

Dr. John L. Norris (Chairman)
Associate Medical Director
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, New York

Dr. Travis E. Dancey
4015 Wilson Avenue
Montreal 28, Quebec, Canada

Dr. Vincent Dole
Rockefeller Inst.
67th St. & York Ave.
New York, New York

Leonard V. Harrison (Trustee Emeritus)
Box 383
Old Lyme, Connecticut

Austin H. McCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30th Street
New York, New York 10016

Robert W. P. Morse
Cove Road
Oyster Bay, L.I., N.Y.

Hon. John Murtagh
Justice of the Supreme Court of
the State of N.Y.
100 Center Street
New York, New York 10013

Archibald B. Roosevelt (Treasurer)
Roosevelt & Cross
40 Wall Street
New York, New York

Bernard B. Smith (Vice-Chairman)
460 Park Avenue
New York, New York 10022

Prof. Harrison M. Trice
School of Industrial Labor Relations
Cornell University
Ithaca, New York

ALCOHOLIC

Tom Breen
1202 — 1305 Grant Avenue
Winnipeg, Manitoba, Canada

R. Fay Brown — Deceased March, 1967
118 Avenue B West
Bismarck, North Dakota

Robert Hitchins
3 Thomas Road
Rockville Centre, L.I., New York

**Eugene Kelley
% Patricia Kelley
565 Fulton Avenue
Hampstead, L.I., New York

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr., Secretary
420 Lexington Avenue
New York, New York

**D. Bruce Mansfield
Ohio Edison Company
47 North Main Street
Akron, Ohio

**Jim Masterson
2525 Landwood Way
Carmichael, California

Frank Russell
159 Wentworth Avenue
Lowell, Massachusetts

Murray Whitsett (2nd Vice-Chairman)
11 Church Street
New Canaan, Connecticut

**Term ending following Conference
(see p. 44 for A.A. Trustees elected
G.S.B. meeting, April 22, 1967)

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Tom White, Editor
Lee Beckwith
David A. Barron
Barry Leach
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr., (Chairman)
Austin McCormick
Robert G. Pearson
Ruth Weir, (Treasurer)
Paula Carpenter, (Secretary)

A.A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

Herb Morse (Chairman)
Eugene Kelley (1st Vice-Chairman)
Eve Marsh (2nd Vice-Chairman)
Murray Whitsett (Treasurer)
Robert Hitchins
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Steve Owens, Sr.
Hazel Rice (Secretary)

GRAPEVINE STAFF

Lee Beckwith
Paula Carpenter

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

Herb Morse
Cora Louise Belford
Beth Kuhlmann
Ann Macfarlane
Eve Marsh
Midge McFadden
Waneta New
Hazel Rice

OTHERS ATTENDING CONFERENCE

G.S.O. DEPT. HEADS

Al Cryan
Rose Failla
Kleina Jones
Dennis Manders
Nell Wing

CONSULTANTS

Janet Graves
(Public Information)
Wilbur A. Smith
(Ind. C.P.A.)

A.A. GRAPEVINE

Jack Morley
(Art Director)

Two Observers from: Public Information Committee
Two Observers from: International Committee
Two Observers from: Grapevine Editorial Board

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

APRIL 1967

Nonalcoholic Trustees

John L. Norris, M.D. ... is Chairman of the General Service Board and the Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. "Dr. Jack" is Associate Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, New York...Chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism...President of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests, he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

Travis Eugene Dancey, M.D. ... Elected to the Board in January 1965. Dr. Dancey is Chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital and Senior Psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital. He has been a good friend of the fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. Group in Quebec. Now he will be the first Class A Trustee to come from Canada to serve regularly.

Vincent P. Dole, M.D. ... Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965. He is a Professor & Senior Physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed method used in the treatment of narcotic addiction; he is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves as co-Chairman of the International Committee, a subcommittee of the General Services Board's Policy Committee.

Austin H. MacCormick ... Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become a Professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as Executive Director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a Director of the A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board.

Robert W. P. Morse ... Elected to the General Service Board in July 1965. Treasurer of the General Service Board and currently Chairman of the Finance and Budgetary Committee. He is Executive Vice President & Treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of Brooklyn. Born in Nova Scotia, Canada he became a U.S. citizen in 1921. During World War II he served as a Finance Officer in the U.S. Army in the Chinese Theatre Area. He is a director of the Mutual Savings Bank Fund & married and the father of three children.

John M. Murtagh ... Elected to the General Service Board April, 1963, is a Justice of the Supreme Court of the State of New York. Previously, he had been Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York, Chief Justice of the Court of Special Sessions, Chief City Magistrate, and Commissioner of Investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. The Judge has long been a good friend of A.A. and comes to the Board with a sure understanding of the alcoholism illness.

Archibald B. Roosevelt (Former Treasurer of the General Service Board and the former Chairman of the Board's Finance & Budgetary Committee) ... was elected to the General Service Board in January 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt and Cross, Inc., and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs. He remains a member of the Board's Finance and Budgetary Committee.

Bernard B. Smith ... is 1st Vice-Chairman of the General Service Board — was elected to the Board in June, 1944 and has been very active, serving as Chairman of the General Service Board and General Service Conference from January, 1951 to April, 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October, 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth II, on her visit to the United States.

Harrison M. Trice, Ph. D. ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1957 and has served there, and as a member of the Literature Committee, with great enthusiasm. He is an Associate Professor in the School of Industrial Labor Relations at Cornell University. He has been a frequent contributor to professional journals, and a consultant to various study groups and to private companies on the subject of alcoholism.

Leonard V. Harrison (Emeritus) first came on the Board in 1941 and, with the exception of his resignation from October, 1950 to January, 1953, has been continually active in A.A. affairs. He served as chairman of the General Service Board from April, 1956 to April, 1961. For many years he served as Director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Connecticut.

A.A. Trustees

Tom Breen ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965. He was nominated by the A.A. Groups in Manitoba, Canada. Has had 10 years of sobriety. He is a Counselor & Public Relations Representative on the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba.

Robert Hitchins ... was elected to the General Service Board in July 1966 and has been a Director of A.A. World Services since July 1964. He is a member of the Trustees Public Information, Literature and International Committees, formerly was Chairman of A.A. Publishing Inc., and of the General Service Committee. Has over 20 years of sobriety and at one time served as Chairman of the New York Intergroup. Currently an executive of a large pharmaceutical advertising agency.

Eugene S. Kelley ... (2nd Vice-Chairman of the General Service Board)—was elected in April 1963. Had served as Director of

A.A. World Services, Inc., since April, 1960. He has served on the Finance Committee of the General Service Board for two years and has been Chairman of the Nominating Committee for the last two years. Has been an active member of the Manhattan Group of New York City since March, 1942. He served as President of New York Intergroup Association Steering Committee from January, 1955 to June, 1956. He has cooperated with the Medical Director of a large corporation in the formation of a policy and plan for the rehabilitation of their alcoholic employees. In non-A.A. life, he has been employed in industrial sales — with the same company for 43 years.

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr. ... was elected to the General Service Board in July 1965. He is Chairman of the A.A. Grapevine, has had 10 years of sobriety. He was admitted to the New York State Bar in 1936 and has his own law firm.

ROSTER

D. Bruce Mansfield... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1964, following nomination at a Conference electoral session where he was Ohio's candidate for the East Central Region. He is presently President of Ohio Edison Company, Akron, Ohio, with which he became associated as General Counsel in 1948. He has been an active member of Ohio Groups since 1945; his current Group is the King School Group of Akron.

Jim Masterson... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, following nomination at electoral session of the General Service Conference where he was California's candidate for the Pacific Region. Has had over 12 years of continuous sobriety. Continuous activity in Northern California Conference Committee, serving his area as Alternate Delegate and Delegate. Is an Executive with the Department of Motor Vehicles in Sacramento. He has been Chairman of The Policy Committee for two years.

Frank E. Russell... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1965 as Trustee from the Northeast Region. He came to A.A. in 1952, in 1954 he helped form the Bridge Street Group of Lowell, Mass. and now the Nashoba Group of Chelmsford. From 1961 - 1962 he served as Delegate to the General Service Conference from Eastern Massachusetts.

Murray Whitsett... (Secretary of the General Service Board) was elected to the Board in April 1964 following two years of service as a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc. He is presently Chairman of the Public Information Committee and a member of the sub-committee of the Finance Committee to study pension programs. Murray has 14 years in A.A., is a member of the New Canaan, Conn. Group. He is a newspaper advertising executive.

Trustees' Meetings

The Board of Trustees will meet during the coming year on the following dates: July 31, October 30, 1967; January 29 and April 27, 1968.

A.A. Trustees elected G.S.B. Meeting, April 22, 1967:

Arthur "Andy" Anderson, Michigan
Eric H. Bergman, Washington
Rollie G. Davidson, Quebec
Katharine Prince, Arkansas
Maurice E. Reilly, Jr., Louisiana
Ruth Weir, New York

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEES

APRIL 1967

FINANCE & BUDGETARY

Robert W.P. Morse, Chairman
Eugene S. Kelley
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
D. Bruce Mansfield
Herbert A. Morse
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Wilbur Smith C.P.A. (Ex-Officio)
Ruth Weir
Beth Kuhlmann, Secretary

Investment Committee

Robert W.P. Morse, Chairman
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Herbert A. Morse
William G. Wilson
Beth Kuhlmann, Secretary

LITERATURE

Austin MacCormick, Chairman
Murray Whitsett, Co-Chairman
Lee Beckwith
Tom Breen
Reverend Yvelin Gardner
Jim Masterson
Frances Mines
Herbert A. Morse
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Joseph Warren
Tom White
Cora Louise Belford, Secretary

NOMINATING

Eugene Kelley, Chairman
Tom Breen
Dr. Travis Dancy
Robert Hitchins
Barry Leach
Austin MacCormick
Jim Masterson
Herbert A. Morse
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Frank Russell
Midge McFadden, Secretary

POLICY

Jim Masterson, Chairman
Tom Breen
Dr. Travis Dancy
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
D. Bruce Mansfield
Herbert A. Morse
Hazel Rice
Frank Russell
Harrison M. Trice
Ruth Weir
Murray Whitsett
Eve Marsh, Secretary

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Murray Whitsett, Chairman
Paula Carpenter
Janet Graves
Robert Hitchins
Rex Moody
Herbert A. Morse
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Tom Rosenberg
Waneta New, Secretary

INTERNATIONAL

Niles Peebles, Chairman
Dr. Vincent Dole, Co-Chairman
Joseph Besch
Norman Crowley
Adrian Frylink
Emma Gardner
Robert Hitchins
Beth Kuhlmann
Herbert A. Morse
William J. Plunkert
Jean Reed, Chmn. Trans. Comm.
Ivan Underwood
Lee Beckwith
Paula Carpenter
Ann Macfarlane, Secretary

(The International Committee is a subcommittee of the G.S.B. Policy Committee.)

1967 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA	(17) John Rockwell, P.O. Box 131, Childersburg, Alabama
ALASKA	(16) *Raleigh Lewis, 302 Cowles, Fair- banks, Alaska
ARIZONA	(16) Paul Roberts, Star Route, Sedona, Arizona
ARKANSAS	(17) Max Hall, 8101 McDaniel, Little Rock, Arkansas
CALIFORNIA	(17) Southern — Jack Oney, 9261½ Bur- ton Way, Beverly Hills, California
	(17) Northern Coastal — Pat Sims, 514 Green Valley Road, Watsonville, California
	(16) Northern Interior — Ken Kott, Route #2, Box 2025, Loomis, California
	(16) San Diego — Rosa Burwell, 4193 Georgia, San Diego, California
	(16) Southern Coastal — Joe Kirk, 38- 132 Charlesworth Way, Cathedral City, California
COLORADO	(17) Ray Gunther, 1532 East Buena Ventura, Colorado Springs, Colo.
CONNECTICUT	(17) Ed Smith, 179 Allyn Street, Hart- ford, Connecticut
DELAWARE	(16) Grover Surratt, P. O. Box 387, Newark, Delaware
D. C.	(17) Ernest Raskauskas, 1418 Ray Rd. Hyattsville, Maryland
FLORIDA	(17) Northern — Harry Gammon, 5883 Hyde Park Circle, Jacksonville, Florida
	(17) Southern — F.E. (Bud) Rose, 1797 Clearwater-Largo Road, Clear- water, Florida
GEORGIA	(16) Virgil Warren, 624 Clairmont Circle, Decatur, Georgia
HAWAII	(17) Wayne Wyman, 2895 Kalakaua Avenue, Honolulu, Hawaii
IDAHO	(16) Wilford Wilcock, 296 Hill Street, Idaho Falls, Idaho
ILLINOIS	(17) Chicago — Harry Veeneman, 10618 Walden Parkway, Chicago, Illinois

What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 17th Conference is made up of Panel 16 — the old Delegates — and Panel 17 — the new Delegates.

STATE	PANEL
	(16) Northern — R. A. "Bud" Welch, 4005 38 Street, Rock Island, Ill.
	(17) Southern — Roy Stimmel, 4902 State Street, East St. Louis, Ill.
INDIANA	(17) Northern — Robert Ellison, 3617 Dover Drive, Fort Wayne, Indiana
	(16) Southern — Robert Wagener, 4422 South Meridian Street, Indianapolis, Indiana
IOWA	(17) John Gilligan, 6301 Sherrick Ave., Des Moines, Iowa
KANSAS	(16) Henry J. Ellenberger, 408 Tank Avenue, Neodesha, Kansas
KENTUCKY	(16) Bernie Schutte, 1206 Larue Ave., Louisville, Kentucky
LOUISIANA	(17) William Watts, 2913 N. General Wainwright, Lake Charles, La.
MAINE	(16) Gordon Pierce, 69 Central Street, Gardiner, Maine
MARYLAND	(16) Ginny Donders, 4713 Mawani Rd., Baltimore, Maryland
MASSACHUSETTS	(17) Eastern — May Comeau, 15 Paul Street, Watertown, Massachusetts
	(16) Western — Roger LaCharite, 22 Percy Street, Chicopee Falls, Massachusetts
MICHIGAN	(17) Central — Robert Budd, 804 Ryan, Owosso, Michigan
	(17) Southeast — Andy Piippo, 14408 Cruse, Detroit, Michigan
	(16) Western — Clarence Knittel, 97 Elkenburg, South Haven, Michigan
MINNESOTA	(16) Northern — Arno Adams, 439 8th Avenue, Waite Park, Minnesota

DELEGATES (cont'd)

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
	(17) Southern — Jim Fairfield, Route Route 2, Box 484, Mound, Minn.		(17) Northeast — Joseph Sharkey, 3804 Harvard Drive, Willoughby, Ohio
MISSISSIPPI	(16) Tyson Lassiter, Box 973, Corinth, Mississippi		(16) N. W. Ohio & S. E. Michigan — Elmer Larson, 106 So. Lynn Street, Bryan, Ohio
MISSOURI	(17) Eastern — Al Gibson, P.O. Box 267, Ilmo, Missouri		(16) South-Southwest Ohio & Northern Kentucky — Bill Johnston, 112 Wrenwood Lane, Terrace Park, Ohio
	(17) Western — Verne Sorrells, 4524 J. C. Nichols Parkway, Kansas City, Missouri		
MONTANA	(16) Earl Poirier, P.O. Box 615, Shelby, Montana	OKLAHOMA	(17) Woody Ward, 11201 North Brauer, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma
NEBRASKA	(16) Kerry Leggett, 305 So. 16th Street, Ord, Nebraska	OREGON	(16) Edward Drozda, 7509 S.E. Reedway, Portland, Oregon
NEVADA	(17) Les Echols, 716 Digger, Las Vegas, Nevada	PENNSYLVANIA	(17) Eastern — Louis Rhodes, 118 So. 50th Street, Philadelphia, Penna.
NEW HAMPSHIRE	(16) George Jordan, Cedar Point, Durham, New Hampshire		(17) Western — Rose Behrhorst, 643 Locust Street, Johnstown, Penna.
NEW JERSEY	(17) Northern — Jamie Deans, 272 Prospect Avenue, Little Silver, New Jersey	RHODE ISLAND	(16) Hiram A. Long, Box 235, Barrington, Rhode Island
	(16) Southern — Paul Hutchins, 7 Shepherd Road, Haddonfield, New Jersey	SOUTH CAROLINA	(16) H. B. "Squire" Jones, P.O. Box 101 North Street, Taylor, S.C.
NEW MEXICO	(16) Robert Flynn, 206 South Tin, Deming, New Mexico	SOUTH DAKOTA	(16) Marty Carlisle, 316 East Pipestone Avenue, Flandreau, South Dakota
NEW YORK	(17) Central — Steve Purtell, 29 Schiller Street, Binghamton, New York	TENNESSEE	(16) Ray Dunkin, 724 Teasel Drive, Kingsport, Tennessee
	(16) Hudson-Mohawk-Berkshire — Joe Curran, 17 Pleasant Avenue, Amsterdam, New York	TEXAS	(17) Northeast — Elizabeth Maddux, 3112 Wild Plum, Fort Worth, Texas
	(17) Southeastern — Tom Mitchell, 16 Carlton Drive, Massapequa, L.I., New York		(16) Northwest — Joe Cleary, 1900 Holloway, Midland, Texas
	(16) Western — Johnny Hutton, 628 25th Street, Niagara Falls, New York		(17) Southeast — Ralph Monroe, 710 13 Avenue, Texas City, Texas
NORTH CAROLINA	(17) Dave Cooke, 229 Dublin Road, Raleigh, North Carolina	UTAH	(16) Southwest — Phillip Schraub, 4302 Ocean Drive, Corpus Christi, Tex.
NORTH DAKOTA	(16) Milly Iverson, 708½ Main Avenue, Bismarck, North Dakota	VERMONT	(17) Pete Sumsion, 890 North First East Street, American Fork, Utah
OHIO	(17) Central & S.E. — Fulton Smedley, R.F.D. 1, Zanesville, Ohio	VIRGINIA	(16) *Orlando Cullinan, Arlington, Vt.
		WASHINGTON	(17) Ernest Francisco, 2741 So. Glebe Road, Arlington, Virginia
			(17) Ralph Bruksos, 102-04 13th Ave., South, Seattle, Washington

DELEGATES (cont'd)

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
WEST VIRGINIA	(17) Sam Morningstar, 1814 Wood St., Wheeling, West Virginia		(17) Southern — Robert White, 1311 S. 72nd Street, West Allis, Wisconsin
WISCONSIN	(16) N. Wisconsin & Upper Michigan — Bert Chapman, P. O. Box 150, Medford, Wisconsin	WYOMING	(16) *Merrill Strong, P. O. Box 131, Evanston, Wyoming
		PUERTO RICO	(16) Guillermo Campos, Calle 5, P 26, Urb Sta. Monica, Bayamon, Puerto Rico
CANADA			
ALBERTA	(16) Ted Knight, 414 15th Street N.W., Calgary, Alberta, Canada		(17) Northeastern—Robert McCullough, 1752 High Street, North Bay, Ont.
BRITISH COLUMBIA— YUKON	(17) Al Huble, 1470 Elm Street, Prince George, B.C., Canada		(17) Northwestern — Vern Constant, 196 Ruttan Street, Port Arthur, Ontario
MANITOBA	(16) J. E. "Jim" Philipps, P. O. Box 334, Boissevain, Manitoba, Can.		(16) Western — Clare Grand, 8 Pavey Street, Chatham, Ontario
NEW BRUNSWICK & PRINCE EDWARD ISL.	(16) Russell Scott, P. O. Box 208, Sackville, New Brunswick, Canada	QUEBEC	(16) English — Belle Holland, P. O. Box 65, Lac Carré, Co. Terre- bonne, P.Q., Canada
NOVA SCOTIA—NEW- FOUNDLAND & LABRADOR	(17) Bill Urquhart, 155 Park Street, Sydney, N.S., Canada		(16) French — Telesphore Bouchard, 7624 Casgrain, Montreal, Quebec, Canada
ONTARIO	(17) Eastern — Pete Watters, 366 Re- becca Street, Oakville, Ontario	SASKATCHEWAN	(16) Ed Laurence, 90 Bailey Drive, Yorktown, Saskatchewan, Canada

** Alternate Delegate*

1967 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES*

Agenda-Admissions

1. Rose Behrhorst, West Pennsylvania
2. Jack Oney, So. California, *CHM*.
3. John Rockwell, Alabama & N.W. Fla.
4. Bill Urquhart, N.S./Newfoundland/Labr.
5. Arno Adams, N. Minnesota
6. Russell Scott, N.B./P.E.I., Canada
7. Grover Surratt, Delaware
8. Bob Wagener, So. Indiana
9. Virgil Warren, Georgia
- Ex. Jim Barber, E. Missouri
- Ex. Frank Chase, S.E., New York
- Ex. Wes James, So. Illinois
- Ex. Walter Thompson, So. Florida
- Secretary - Midge McFadden
- Acting Secretary - Hazel Rice

Grapevine

1. Vern Constant, N.W., Ontario
2. Les Echols, Nevada, *CHM*.
3. Harry Gammon, No. Florida
4. Ernest Raskauskas, D.C.
5. Woody Ward, Oklahoma
6. Marty Carlisle, So. Dakota
7. Joe Cleary, N.W. Texas
8. Joe Curran, (H.M.B.) New York
9. Bill Johnston, S.W. Ohio & No. Ky.
10. Wilford Wilcock, Idaho
- Ex. George Dvorak, No. New Jersey
- Ex. Bob Pritchard, N.S. & Nfld. & Labr.
- Ex. Ed Hartsock, N. Coastal, Calif.
- Ex. Hollis Akins, Arkansas
- Secretary - Paula Carpenter

Policy

1. Ernest Francisco, Virginia
2. Steve Purtell, Cen. N.Y., *CHM*
3. Pat Sims, N. Coastal California
4. Fulton Smedley, Central & S.E. Ohio
5. Ken Kott, N. Int. California
6. Bert Chapman, N. Wisc. & Upper Mich.
7. Ed Drozda, Oregon
8. Tyson Lassiter, Mississippi
9. Kerry Leggett, Nebraska
10. Gordon Pierce, Maine
- Ex. Eric Bergman, Washington
- Ex. Keet Rader, W. Missouri
- Ex. Harry Barrett, N. Carolina
- Ex. Mike Rainbolt, Oklahoma
- Ex. Bert Lynch, N. Florida
- Secretary - Eve Marsh

Conference Report & Charter

1. Jamie Deans, No. N. Jersey
2. Robert Ellison, No. Indiana
3. Al Gibson, Eastern Missouri
4. Elizabeth Maddux, N.E. Texas
5. William Watts, Louisiana, *CHM*.
- *6. Orlando Cullinan, Vermont
7. Henry Ellenberger, Kansas
8. Earl Poirier, Montana
9. Paul Roberts, Arizona
10. Bud Welch, No. Illinois
- Ex. Cora "Tommy" Dayton, Connecticut
- Ex. Tom Pickens, Iowa
- Ex. Garfield Kyer, N.N.W., Ont., Canada
- Ex. Ralph McPherson, Cent. Michigan
- Ex. Alf McGowan, E. Ont., Canada
- Secretary - Nell Wing

Institutions

1. Ralph Bruksos, Washington
2. Robert Budd, Central Michigan
3. May Comeau, Eastern Massachusetts
4. John Gilligan, Iowa
5. F.E. (Bud) Rose, So. Fla., *CHM*.
6. Ray Dunkin, Tennessee
7. Belle Holland, Que., Canada
8. Paul Hutchins, So. N.J.
9. Milly Iverson, N. Dakota
10. Jim Philipps, Man., Canada
- Ex. Clarence Topel, So. Wisconsin
- Ex. Hal Potter, D.C.
- Ex. Jerry Wilson, S.E. Texas
- Ex. Ross Stanton, No. Indiana
- Secretary - Cora Louise Belford
- Acting Secretary - Ann Macfarlane

Public Information

1. Max Hall, Arkansas
- *2. Verne Sorrells, W. Missouri
3. Roy Stimmel, So. Illinois
4. Pete Watters, Eastern Ontario
5. Wayne Wyman, Hawaii *CHM*.
6. Ginny Donders, Maryland
7. Johnny Hutton, W. New York
8. Joe Kirk, S. Coastal California
9. Elmer Larson, N.W. Ohio & S.E. Mich.
10. Hiram Long, Rhode Island
- Ex. Jim Hawkins, Ala. & N.W. Florida
- Ex. Jan Armstrong, B.C., Canada
- Ex. Morris McFarland, N.E. Texas
- Ex. Harold Hayhurst, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
- Ex. Bill Coogan, E. Massachusetts
- Secretary - Waneta New

Finance

1. Robert McCullough, N.E. Ontario
2. Ralph Monroe, S.E. Texas
3. Joseph Sharkey, N.E. Ohio
4. Ed Smith, Connecticut, *CHM*.
5. Robert White, So. Wisconsin
6. Robert Flynn, New Mexico
7. Clare Grand, W. Ont., Canada
8. Ted Knight, Alberta, Canada
9. Roger LaCharite, W. Mass.
- *10. Raleigh Lewis, Alaska
- Ex. Bob Daly, So. Minnesota
- Ex. Ralph Searle, Utah
- Ex. Jim Griffin, Chicago, Illinois
- Ex. Sheldon Bradshaw, Cen. New York
- Ex. Jack McCarthy, W. Virginia
- Secretary - Beth Kuhlmann

Literature

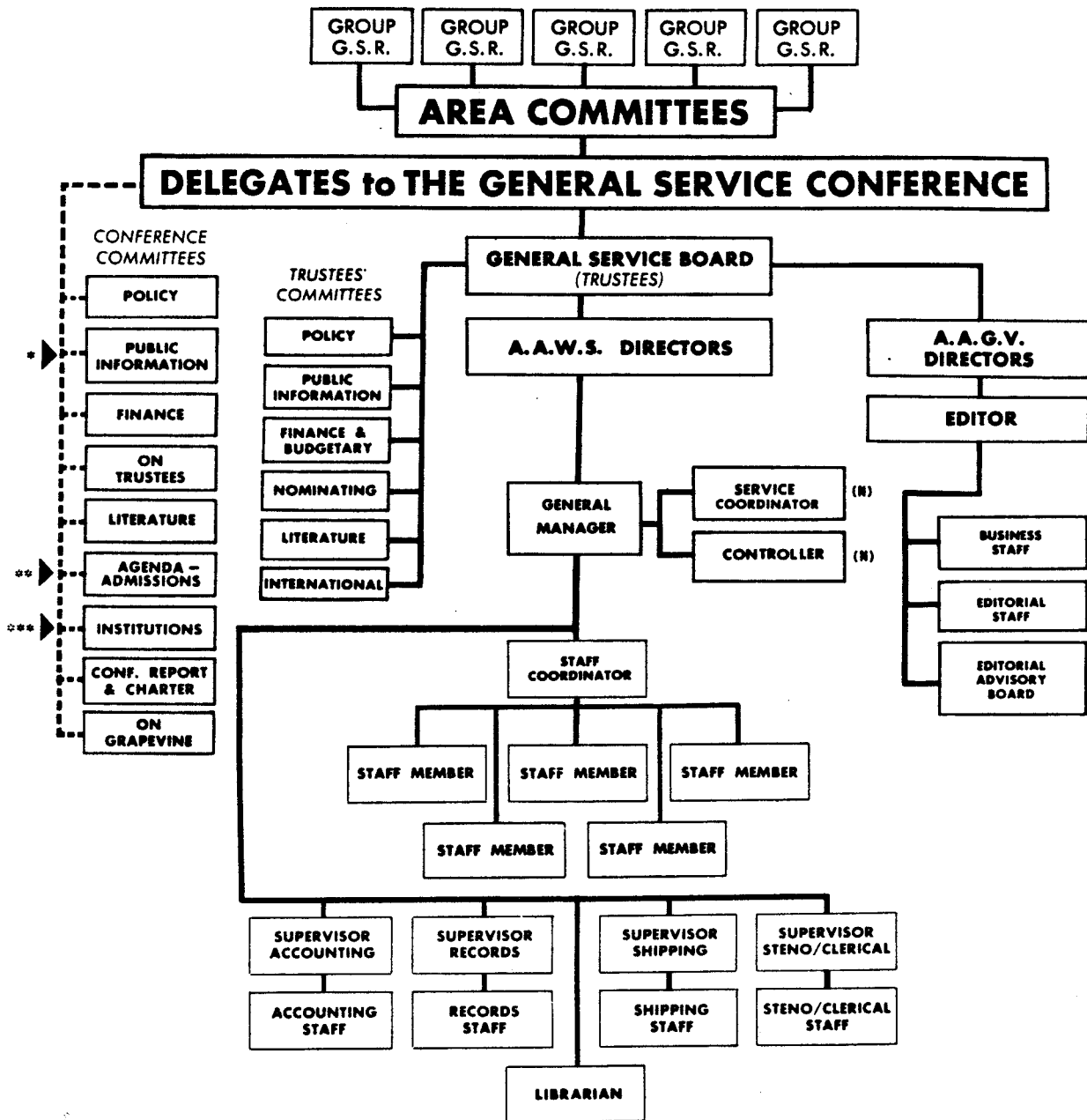
1. Dave Cooke, No. Carolina
2. Ray Gunther, Colorado
3. Andy Pilippo, S.E. Michigan
4. Louis Rhodes, E. Pennsylvania, *CHM*.
5. Pete Sumsion, Utah
6. Rosa Burwell, San Diego, Calif.
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9. George Jordan, New Hampshire
10. Phillip Schraub, S.W. Texas
- Ex. Ray Free, Nevada
- Ex. Scotty Sewell, S.E. Michigan
- Ex. Gail S. Jones, E. Pennsylvania
- Ex. Earl Felton, Virginia
- Ex. Ray Murphy, W. Pennsylvania
- Secretary - Cora Louise Belford

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- *6. Merrill Strong, Wyoming
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- Ex. Charles Gresser, N.E. Ohio
- Ex. Maurice Reilly, Louisiana
- Ex. Butch Cline, Hawaii
- Secretary - Midge McFadden

*Alternate Delegate

STRUCTURE OF THE FELLOWSHIP



* NAME CHANGED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

** COMBINED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

*** CREATED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

(N) ESTABLISHED BY A.A.W.S. IN 1966

I am responsible...

**When anyone, anywhere,
reaches out for help, I want
the hand of A.A. always to be there.
And for that: I am responsible.**



Not the End, But a New Beginning